LISTEN, PROCESS, RESPOND

The Sales System for People Who Actually Give a Damn

By
Ben Schulz

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FOREWORD

I Wrote This Book Because My Funnel Failed

I didn't set out to write a book about handling objections. Hell, I thought I had this whole sales thing figured out. I'd built Algorithm Collective from the ground up, reverse-engineered how AI recommendation systems work, created a proprietary 70+ factor methodology, and developed a killer service that helps businesses get noticed by Claude, ChatGPT, and the rest of the AI gang for under a hundred bucks.

My funnel was beautiful. Free visibility tests get them interested. A $99 audit shows them exactly what's wrong. Then boom implementation packages ranging from $997 to $2,997 to fix their problems. Simple, right? Except nobody was buying. Well, that's not entirely true. People were interested. They loved the free test. They thought the $99 audit was a steal compared to the thousands they'd been throwing at SEO companies. But when it came time to pull the trigger on the implementation packages? Crickets.
"I need to think about it." "Let me talk to my partner." "Can you send me some information?" "It's a bit expensive right now."

I heard every excuse in the book. And here's the thing that really pissed me off I knew they needed what I was selling. I could see it in

their audit results. Their businesses were invisible to AI. They were losing customers to competitors who were getting recommended by ChatGPT and Claude while they weren't even in the conversation. But I was losing them. Every single time.

So, I did what any stubborn bastard would do I started practicing. Not with real customers. I wasn't about to burn more leads while I figured this out. I started role-playing objection handling with Claude AI, going through scenario after scenario, testing different approaches, getting feedback, trying again. And something clicked.

I realized I'd been approaching objections all wrong. I'd been treating them like roadblocks to get around, like no's I had to turn into yeses. But that's not what objections are at all.
Objections are puzzles. And once you solve them, the sale is yours. That mindset shift changed everything. Within weeks, I was closing deals I would've lost before. The same objections that used to shut me down became opportunities to understand what the customer actually needed to hear.
"It's too expensive" wasn't really about money it was about not seeing the value yet.

"I need to think about it" wasn't about needing time it was about being afraid of making the wrong decision.
"I'm happy with my current provider" wasn't about satisfaction it was about fear of change. Once I understood that, everything got easier

and I started closing those implementation packages. This book is everything I learned from that process. Not theory from some sales guru who hasn't made a cold call in twenty years. These are real techniques that worked for me when my business was on the line and I had to figure this shit out or fail.

If you're tired of hearing objections and losing sales, this book is for you. If you're sick of that sinking feeling when someone says, "let me think about it" and you know you'll never hear from them again, this book is for you.

I'm not going to teach you to be pushy or manipulative. I'm going to teach you to listen really listen and solve the actual problem your customer is having, even when they don't know what that problem is themselves. Let's get started.

CHAPTER 1

Why Most People Fail At Handling Objections

Opening

I never thought I had any sales talent. When I did telemarketing years ago, I was actually pretty good at it maybe too good. I could get people so worked up about credit card insurance that they'd go out to their cars to get their credit cards. But it felt terrible.

The breaking point came when a 90-year-old woman started rattling off her Social Security number and credit card details because my script had filled her with so much paranoia. She asked, "Do I really need this, honey?" And I told her the truth: "You're 90 years old. If you haven't had credit card problems by now, you probably don't need this." That's when I quit.
For years after that, I thought sales meant manipulation. Push people until they break down and buy something they don't need.

Then one night in November 2025, everything changed. I was talking with Claude, my AI assistant, about my business Algorithm Collective. We were practicing how to handle customer objections you know, when people say, "it's too expensive" or "I need to think about it." Something magical happened. When Claude threw objections at me,

I didn’t get defensive. I didn’t feel attacked. I didn't have to sit down and plan everything out. The responses just flowed naturally. It was like a puzzle I could solve instantly.

And then I realized: I wasn’t pushing anyone. I was just putting Claude at ease. That’s pretty much all it was. For the first time in my life, objections felt like a game I could win not through manipulation or pressure, but through understanding what people really needed and giving them permission to make the right decision. That’s when I discovered that sales doesn’t have to feel bad. When done right, it feels like helping.

Section 1: The Fear Factor

Let me tell you about the time I learned what real rejection feels like. I was working at a machine shop as a CNC machinist. The company had just gone through an ISO audit and failed miserably specifically on their website documentation. They couldn’t prove their capabilities to potential customers because their online presence was a disaster.
I had been teaching myself web development for about two weeks at that point. Nothing fancy, just YouTube tutorials and trial-and-error learning. But I saw an opportunity to help the company and maybe prove I was worth more than just running machines.

So, I went to one supervisor we can call him Dan and said, “Hey, I noticed we failed the ISO audit because of the website. I’ve been learning web development. I think I can fix this.”

Dan was skeptical but interested. "What exactly could you do?"
"I can rebuild the website to show our capabilities properly. Add a working contact form, integrate Google Maps so customers can find us, create a quote request system. All the stuff the auditors said we were missing." He thought about it for a moment. "Alright, show me what you can do."

I spent the next two weeks reverse-engineering every element of what a proper manufacturing website needed. I taught myself form integration, map embedding, database connections, everything required to make the site actually functional instead of just a pretty placeholder. When I finally had it working, I was genuinely proud. I showed it to everyone who would look other machinists, supervisors, even the receptionist. "Look, the Google Maps integration works! You can request quotes right through the form! Everything the ISO auditors wanted is here!"

People were impressed. Dan seemed pleased. For a moment, I thought I might have found a way to be more valuable to the company than just another pair of hands on the shop floor.
Then Bob, one of the managers, walked by my station. I couldn't help myself I was excited about what I'd built. "Hey Bob, check this out! I rebuilt the company website. It's got everything we need for the ISO requirements now." He glanced at my screen for maybe three seconds.

"That's great," he said flatly. "But you should probably stay in your lane and focus on machining." That was it. No "thank you for the initiative." No "let's see if we can use this." Just a dismissive comment that made it clear he saw me as a machinist, period. Nothing more. I went to the bathroom and just stood there for a minute, collecting myself. Not because I was going to cry or anything dramatic like that, I just needed a moment to process what had just happened.

I'd spent two weeks teaching myself new skills, solved a real problem the company had, and got told to "stay in my lane."
Here's what I realized during those few minutes staring at myself in that bathroom mirror: Bob's rejection had nothing to do with the quality of my work. He didn't even look at the website long enough to evaluate it. His response was about ego and hierarchy, not merit. If he had said, "Ben, this is impressive work, but we've already contracted with a web development firm," I would have understood.

If he'd said, "This is great, but we need someone with professional credentials for ISO compliance," that would have made sense. If he'd even said, "Let me review this properly and get back to you," I could have respected that. But "stay in your lane"? That wasn't about my work. That was about Bob needing to remind me and probably himself where I stood in the company hierarchy.

That realization changed everything for me. Because once I understood that rejection often says more about the person delivering

it than the person receiving it, I stopped taking rejections personally. Most people fail at handling objections because they're terrified of rejection. And they're terrified of rejection because they think it's a judgment of their worth. When someone says "no" to their product, service, or idea, they hear "you're not good enough."

But here's the truth I learned in that Glen Carbide bathroom: rejection is almost never about you. It's about the other person's circumstances, insecurities, priorities, or simple misunderstandings. Bob's rejection of my website work taught me more about handling objections than any sales training ever could. It taught me that when someone rejects what you're offering, you need to understand what they're actually rejecting and why because it's usually not what you think.

The mindset shift that changes everything.

The most important point of this whole book is to change your mind set on sales. Change your mind set on objections. Stop taking them as nos. Stop getting your feelings hurt. These aren't "no, we don't like you." These aren't "no, we don't like what you have to offer." These are "for one reason or another, we just don't feel comfortable saying yes." So, what we need you to do as the salesperson is talk us through this and make us feel comfortable. Make us ready to give ourselves permission to buy into this. "It costs too much" isn't always about money.

"I don't have time" isn't always about time. "I can't make this decision without talking to somebody" well, you make how many decisions a day without talking to somebody? Suddenly, I have something to offer you, and you need to talk to your whole board? No. You just need to go in there and look at it as a puzzle.

We keep using the puzzle analogy because once you solve them, that sale is yours. And you have a happy customer. A happy salesman. And the next time you call them up, they're going to listen to you right from the jump. Because you have talked to them before and treated them like human beings. So, the next time you call them up, they're going to listen to every word you have to say. And if it's something they need, they're going to do the sale for you. Because you stopped taking their objections at face value and got to the root. That's why.

Section 2: The Pushy Salesperson Myth

You want to know what my old thoughts about sales were? Walk into any car lot in the United States, and that was sales to me. Three guys rushing and tripping over each other to get to you because they want to sell you a car. They're trying to hike up the down payment to get more money in their pockets. They can't even let you look on your own.

"What do you want? What kind of car? What make? What model? What size tires?"

I don't know. I'm not even sure. I just want to look until I see something I like. That's when I'll know. But they can't let you get a

breath in edgewise. As soon as you walk on the lot, it's like hunting grounds. And you're the prey. I used to try to go to car dealerships when they were closed, hoping I could just look at cars. I think that's why Carvana took off so much it took the salesman out of the picture.

When I think of salespeople, do you know what I think of? That movie Matilda. The little girl with magic abilities, and her dad is a car salesman who's always running transmissions backward to take miles off cars and putting sawdust in engines to make them quiet. That is the picture I get in my head when I think of a salesman. But tonight, I realized something completely different. You don't have to be that sleazy, beady-eyed car salesman selling the duct-taped car as brand new.

Tonight, I realized that objections are just hurdles. Something isn't clicking in that person's head, and you need to help them solve that puzzle in their head. You're not hunting them, you're helping them figure out what they actually need. That's not manipulation. That's problem-solving.

Section 3: The Permission Problem

The objection that changed everything for me tonight was when someone said, "I've been ripped off by a company like this before." My first instinct should have been to get defensive or try to argue why

I'm different. Instead, something clicked. What I actually heard was: "I'm interested, but I'm afraid. I don't want to look like a fool again." That wasn't them saying they don't like me or my product. Think about it they have the ultimate "no" available to them. All they have to do is say "no" and walk away. If you're on the phone, all they have to do is hang up.

If they're still on the phone with you, still talking to you, there's a reason. And that chance is still there. All you have to do is figure out why they're still engaged. I figured out they were afraid. They'd been burned before. So, my job wasn't to convince them to buy it was to make them feel safe. Show them my company was honorable. A stand-up operation. "Here's my personal number. We're not scammers. You can call me anytime you need to."

They weren't saying they don't want me or my product. They were just saying, "I'm scared." Once I understood that, everything changed. Objections stopped feeling like rejection and started feeling like invitations to help someone feel safe enough to say yes.

Section 4: The Preparation Gap

Let's be honest. When you don't have a plan, you're going to be nervous to begin with. You're going to be afraid. You're going to be stumbling over your words. When you don't have a plan, you're not listening to what the person's saying to you. Because you're too busy thinking about what you're going to say back. But when you have that

plan in your head, then you already know the answer's in there. You just have to be calm. So let me listen to what they're really saying to me.

That's the biggest part. You need to decipher what they're really saying. Not what their body language is saying. None of that old-school stuff. Is their left eye blinking or their right eye blinking? Or their pinky moving? None of that. You need to listen with your ears and figure out the real problem you need to solve. If you're prepared, then it just rolls right off your tongue. I was never prepared before.

That's what the Listen-Process-Respond framework gave me tonight. When someone threw an objection at me, I wasn't scrambling for words. I knew I had a system: listen to what they're really saying, process what they actually need, then respond to their real concern. Preparation didn't make me robotic it made me calm enough to be human.

Section 5: Your Story

I mean, machining the problem with machining is it seems like everything is filled with stress. Every number must be right. Every machine setting must be right. If it isn't, you're crashing the machine. You're ruining parts. Somebody's pissed off at you. Somebody's mad at you. Tonight, when I answered that first objection, like I said, it was the first time I've done anything like this. I answered it, and I answered

it without scrambling. I didn't have to think. I didn't have to try to grab my phone and Google anything.

When I answered that first objection, for the first time in my life, I wasn't apprehensive. I just went slowly and answered it.
And after I answered it, I realized, "Wait. That really went easy. It must have just been an easy question." And Claude came back and said, "Wow. You did a great job. "Do you want to try another one?" And I'm like, "Yeah. Let's go again." That's when I knew something had changed. In machining, I dread the next problem. Tonight, I was asking for the next objection. I was having fun. For the first time in years, I'd found work that didn't feel like work.

Closing

By the end of this book, you'll see objections the way I do as a game you can win every time. Not through manipulation or pressure, but through understanding what people really need and giving them permission to say yes.

CHAPTER 2

The Psychology Behind Why People Object

Opening

Most people think objections are about what the customer is saying. They're not. Objections are about what the customer is protecting. When someone says "no" to you, they're rarely rejecting your product, your service, or even your price. They're protecting something much deeper, their ego, their authority, their fear of looking stupid, or their sense of control. Once you understand this, objections stop feeling like personal attacks and start feeling like puzzles you can solve.

Let me show you what I mean through some stories from my own lifetimes when I was the one getting defensive, times when I watched others get defensive, and times when I finally understood what was really happening beneath the surface objections.

Section 1: When You're the One Getting Defensive

A while back, I was just starting to build Algorithm Collective. I was excited about it coming up with flyers, working on the website, figuring out how to position the service. I sent a flyer draft to my buddy Neegles to get his thoughts. He looked it over and said, "Okay. Well, the back is too dark, and I want to talk to you about the wording."

My instant reaction? Forget it. I'm not discussing this with him.
Now, here's the thing Neegles wasn't attacking me. He was trying to help. But in that moment, all I heard was criticism. My brain immediately went defensive: "Who is he to know my business better than I know my business? Who is he to say anything about the wording?"

The truth is, I wasn't rejecting his feedback because it was bad. I was rejecting it because I was afraid. Afraid that maybe he'd do a better job than me. Afraid that his ideas might be better than mine. Afraid of losing control over something I'd built.
Looking back now, I owe Neegles an apology. Maybe he was right. But in that moment, my ego wouldn't let me hear him.
That's what objections really are. They're not about the thing being discussed. They're about what's happening inside the person's head.

Section 2: When Someone Else Gets Defensive

Here's the flip side. I was working at Glen Carbide, and we had a new guy named Vlad who'd just started. He was taking over for Ronnie, one of the old-timers, and he was working on a case that needed to go up to EDM to get the back cut out. I looked over and noticed he was about to drill the back hole with a number 5 center drill which is about two or three times bigger than what the hole size was supposed to be. If he drilled that hole, he'd ruin the part.

So I walked over and said, "Hey, bud. Let me make a suggestion." He flipped out on me. Right there in the shop. "I don't take suggestions from you. You're not my boss. You don't tell me what to do." Now, my first instinct was to get back in his face and ask him exactly who he thought he was. But I stopped myself. I went into the office and talked to Bob, one of the managers. I explained what happened that I'd just tried to help Vlad avoid a costly mistake, and he'd blown up at me.

Bob agreed with me. He said Vlad shouldn't have responded like that, and even if he didn't like the suggestion, he should've just said, "Thanks, but I'm gonna do it my way." Eventually, Vlad apologized. We put it behind us. But here's what I realized: Vlad wasn't mad at me. He was afraid that by making a suggestion, I was making him look dumb. That's what it came down to. Me making a suggestion felt like me correcting him or making him look stupid especially as the new guy trying to prove he belonged.

The objection "I don't take suggestions from you"—wasn't about my suggestion at all. It was about his fear of looking incompetent.

Section 3: When Authority Gets in the Way

Here's another one. Chuck and I, both machinists at Glen Carbide, were having a problem with mandrels. When we brazed them, they weren't staying together. They were coming apart really easy. We tinkered around, changed this and that, and finally figured it out: if we just used soap and water to clean them no other chemicals they stayed together perfectly. We could hit them with hammers, and they wouldn't come apart.

The problem was the ink remover we'd been using to clean them before brazing. It was leaving a residue that prevented the bond from holding.

So, we went to Bob with our solution. We showed him the results. We had proof it worked. Bob said, "No. It's not the ink remover. It's the way we're doing it." He made us switch to denatured alcohol instead of soap and water. It was better than the ink remover, but it wasn't as good as what we'd discovered.

Here's what Bob couldn't bring himself to say: "Hey, look what my guys came up with. They fixed this problem on their own. Man, I'm proud of them."

Instead, what he was thinking was: "These guys came up with this on their own. They're gonna think they're smarter than me now and challenge me all the time. I have to shut this down."
Bob wasn't rejecting our solution because it didn't work. He was rejecting it because accepting it would've threatened his authority. It would've meant admitting that two machinists had figured out something he couldn't. The objection wasn't about the ink remover. It was about protecting his position.

Section 4: The Permission Framework

People need permission to change their minds. This might sound simple, but it's one of the most powerful psychological principles in objection handling. Let me tell you about Kelly. Kelly was dealing with something most people can't even imagine her house had burned down. Everything gone. She was living in a hotel with her family, trying to rebuild her life from scratch, and facing an overwhelming mountain of decisions about reconstruction. When I talked to her about helping with her situation, she immediately said, "I can't afford this right now. Everything's going into rebuilding."

Now, here's what most salespeople would have done at that point: pushed harder, explained payment plans, tried to convince her the

investment was worth it despite her circumstances. Classic objection handling, right? But I understood what Kelly was really saying. She wasn't rejecting my help she was protecting herself from making another decision she might regret. When your house has burned down and you're making a thousand crucial choices about reconstruction, insurance, temporary housing, and family stability, your brain goes into defensive mode. Every new decision feels like a potential mistake. So instead of pushing, I said something that surprised her: "Kelly, you're absolutely right to be cautious about spending money right now. With everything you're dealing with, you need to be smart about every dollar." I watched her shoulders relax. Finally, someone who understood instead of trying to sell her something. Then I continued: "But here's what I want you to consider. You're going to rebuild that house, right?"
"Of course."

"And when you rebuild it, you're going to want to make sure people can find your business again, right? Because right now, if someone searches for what you do in your area, they might not find you while you're displaced." She hadn't thought about that. "That's true... "So, the question isn't really 'can you afford this right now?' The question is: can you afford to lose potential customers while you're rebuilding? Because if people can't find you online for the next six months while you're getting back on your feet, that's lost revenue you'll never get back."

I just gave Kelly permission to think about her situation differently. Not by pressuring her or manipulating her circumstances, but by reframing what "affording it" actually meant in her specific situation. She didn't buy immediately and I didn't expect her to. But three days later, she called back: "I've been thinking about what you said. You're right. I can't afford NOT to maintain my online presence while I'm rebuilding. Let's do this."

Here's what happened in that conversation: Kelly came in with an objection based on her immediate emotional response to her traumatic situation. My job wasn't to overcome that objection through pressure or persuasion. My job was to give her permission to see her situation from a different angle. The Permission Framework works because it acknowledges that people's initial objections are often their brain's way of protecting them from risk. When you validate that protective instinct instead of fighting it, you create space for them to think clearly about what they actually need.

Most objections aren't logical, they're emotional. And you can't logic someone out of an emotional position. But you can give them permission to reconsider their position by showing them you understand their concerns and offering a new perspective that serves their actual interests. When someone says, "I can't afford it," they're often really saying "I'm scared of making the wrong financial decision." When you validate that fear and then show them why NOT buying might be the riskier financial decision, you've given them

permission to change their mind without feeling foolish about their initial resistance.
That's the Permission Framework. It's not about overcoming objections it's about creating psychological safety for people to reconsider their position.

Section 5: When You Don't Trust Someone

Here's one more. Years ago, when I was making rap music, I had a buddy named John who lived out in California. He told me about this big show with all these headlining rappers. He sent me a contract. I was excited. I told all my friends. But something felt off. He kept messaging me, saying he needed money. He'd pawned his watches. The whole thing felt weird. Then I looked at the contract more closely the date was from last year. I thought, "This guy's not being truthful."

I didn't say no to John because the opportunity sounded bad. I said no because I didn't trust him. And I was right there was no rap show. He'd printed up a fake contract he found online. He kept stringing me along until the fake show date came and went, and he finally had to admit he was lying.
My objection "I'm not interested" wasn't about the show. It was about trust. My bullshit detector was way too strong.

Section 6: Decision Paralysis

Let me tell you about decision paralysis. Here's what it is the more options you give people, the more likely they are to freeze up and start overthinking every little thing. That's why when you present your sales options, you want to make them simple. Not a lot of choices.

Down to earth. You make it A and you make it B. You don't go A, B, C, D, E, F, G. And if you pick A, you got to pick element P. If you pick B, you have got to pick Q, R, S. The more decisions, the more chance there is that decision paralysis is going to creep in and they're just going to totally shut down. They're not going to want to pick anything. They're going to panic inside, shut the whole system down, and they're not gonna want to take on anything. So, you frame the question for them. Instead of "Out of all these options, what do you want?" you say, "Okay.

Do you want A or do you want B?" That makes it a lot easier for them to say, "Oh, well, that's an easy decision. Do you want the $99 audit? Do you want the $299 audit? Oh, that's an easy answer. I want the $99 audit. Okay. Perfect. Let's go ahead and sign you up. Let me get your website, get your name, get your number, your email. In 24 to 48 hours, I'll have this in your inbox." That's how you want to present it and frame it, so they're not agonizing over all these different choices. Some people think, "Well, the more choices I offer, the better chance they're gonna pick something." No. Not true. I promise it ain't true.

Section 7: Loss Aversion

Now let's talk about loss aversion. The principle is this: people feel the pain of losing something twice as much as they feel the joy of gaining something new. In sales, what that means is if they have a process and you come in and suggest a new process, the pain of losing that old process is twice as heavy as their joy of gaining a new process that actually works.

Even though their whole process isn't working, they're afraid to switch to this new one. The new process they don't know is scarier than the old process that doesn't work. And that leads to a lot of objections like "Well, I have to talk to my partner" or "I'm happy with my current provider." Most of that comes from loss aversion. They're basically saying, "I'm afraid of change." They're not saying they don't like you. They don't want your product.
They're saying, "Look, I'm sorry, but I'm a human being. I'm afraid of change. I need you to help me make this feel okay so I can embrace this change." That's what loss aversion really is about helping someone be okay making the change. So, you can tell them: "You don't have to change your old process. If you think your old process works for you, that's fine. You can keep it. You can run our process in addition to your old process. You don't have to change anything.

This is just another layer added on top to make your business stronger. You don't have to get rid of your old provider. We'll work hand in hand with your provider. There's no reason you got to get rid of them. I can work with him. And I'm sure he can work with me."

Closing

Do you see the pattern? When Neegles gave me feedback, I got defensive because I was afraid he'd show me up. When I suggested a fix to Vlad, he got defensive because he was afraid of looking incompetent. When Chuck and I solved the mandrel problem, Bob rejected it because accepting it threatened his authority. When I tried to help Kelly, she resisted because admitting she needed help felt like losing control. When John offered me an opportunity, I rejected it because I didn't trust him.

None of these objections were about the thing being discussed. They were all about fear, ego, control, or trust. Here's what you need to remember: the customer isn't rejecting you. They're telling you they have a fear of something, and you need to figure out what that fear is. Once you solve that fear, they'll be more than willing to go with the sale.

Use additional language, not replacement language. Explain that your process is gonna work with theirs, not replace theirs. Their old system has been in place forever, and even if it isn't working, it's what feels right. Find a way to put it in their head: "Our process is gonna work hand in hand with your process. We're not trying to replace your process."

And always simplify choices. Start with A or B. Don't give them a huge range of options. If you're selling them a Kia Optima, ask "Do

you want this in red, or do you want it in silver?" You're not gonna ask them what liter engine they want, how many gears, automatic or manual no. You're gonna keep it simple.

Start easy. "You want a red car or a silver car?" Get that answer. Build from there. Once they tell you red then you move to "Okay. Are you looking for manual or automatic?" But if you just go up to them and say, "List every option you want on the car," they're going to freeze up. Decision paralysis is gonna take over, and you're going to end up with a customer who says, "You know what? Maybe I should come back and do this again another day." And they're gonna end up going somewhere where the salesman holds their hand through the process instead of dumping everything on their lap.

Once you understand that objections are about what people are protecting not what they're rejecting, you stop taking them personally. You stop getting defensive. You stop feeling attacked. Instead, you start asking yourself: What is this person really protecting? What are they afraid of? What do they need to feel safe enough to say yes?

When you figure that out, objections stop being obstacles. They become invitations to help someone feel confident, safe, and in control of their decision. That's when sales stop feeling like a battle and start feeling like problem-solving. And that's when you start winning.

CHAPTER 3

The Listen-Process-Respond Framework

Opening

I never thought I'd say this, but there was a night when objection handling stopped feeling like a nightmare and started feeling like a game I could actually win. It happened in November 2025. I was talking with Claude, my AI assistant, about Algorithm Collective. We were working on how to handle customer objections you know, when people say, "it's too expensive" or "I need to think about it." All the stuff that used to make me want to crawl under a rock. Claude said, "Okay. Let's handle some objections." And the first thing I felt was terror. Pure terror. "Do we really have to do this? Maybe we can skip this and come back to it." Because my whole life, I've never been equipped with the ability to handle objections. Or at least, I didn't know that I was.

Section 1: How I Used to Handle Objections

Here's what used to happen: Someone would start telling me their objection, and I wouldn't even be listening. While they were still talking, I'd be racing through my head trying to hurry up and think of what I was gonna say back. I was scrambling, trying to come up with

the answer before they even finished explaining what their problem was. That system cannot work.

You can't solve a problem when you're not even listening to what the problem is. You're too busy panicking about your response to actually hear what they're saying. When you don't have a plan, you're going to be nervous to begin with. You're going to be afraid. You're going to be stumbling over your words.

Section 2: The Breakthrough

But that night, something changed. When Claude threw that first objection at me, I didn't scramble. I didn't panic. I didn't have to grab my phone and Google anything. I just… answered it. And after I answered it, I thought, "Wait. That really went easy. It must have just been an easy question." Claude said, "Wow. You did a great job. Do you want to try another one?" And I said, "Yeah. Let's go again."

That's when I knew something had changed. In machining, I dread the next problem. But that night, I was asking for the next objection. I was having fun. For the first time in years, I'd found work that didn't feel like work.

Section 3: Empty Your Mind and Listen

Here's what I learned that night: You must empty your mind and listen to what they're saying to you. Fully process what they're telling you. Sometimes you gotta dig deep and separate that puzzle in there to see what the real problem is. That became my framework: Listen. Process. Respond. Listen not while you're thinking about your answer but actually listen. Empty your mind. Hear what they're saying.

Process figure out what they really mean. What they say and what they mean are two totally different things. Respond to what they need, not to the words they used. When you have that plan in your head, then you already know the answer's in there. "I just have to be calm. So let me listen to what they're really saying to me." That's the biggest part. You need to decipher what they're really saying.

Not what their body language is saying. None of that old-school stuff. Is their left eye blinking or their right eye blinking? Or their pinky moving? None of that. You need to listen with your ears and figure out the real problem you need to solve.
If you're prepared, then it just rolls right off your tongue. I was never prepared before.

Section 4: What They Say vs. What They Mean

When someone says, "I don't have time for this right now," what do they really mean? They might mean, "I'm not sure this is gonna work." Think about it. If they're still on the phone with you, still talking to you, there's a reason. That chance is still there. All you have to do is

figure out why they're still engaged. They're not saying they don't want your product. They're saying, "I'm scared. I don't want to look like a fool again."

So, your job isn't to convince them to buy. Your job is to make them feel safe. Here's how you do it: One by one, you break those things apart until you get to the root of what they're really asking you. Let's say they say, "I don't have time." You explain how it works. They still say, "I just don't have time." That tells you their real question isn't about logistics. Maybe they're asking you to show them the value.

Make them excited about this. You need to make them see that value. Maybe they don't trust you because they don't know you. Make them trust you. That's what your job is. You need to dig in there and figure out what they're really telling you.

Section 5: The LPR Framework in Action

Let me show you how this works in a real conversation. I've approached somebody about my AIO services. And they told me, "Well, you know what? We just don't have the money right now." So, the first thing I did was listen. And what they said was, "We don't have the money right now." But I knew that wasn't their true answer. Because it's a business.

They're spending all these expenses. And you can even ask them, "Well, how much did you spend on SEO last month?" And most people will tell you because you're trying to help them. And they'll say, "Oh, well, last month, we spent about $3,000 on SEO." Okay. Well, now you know for sure the issue isn't money. Just by using that listening step, you know if they can spend $3,000 on SEO, they can spend $99 on an audit.

So, then you process. Okay. It isn't about money. There's something else wrong. And you kind of tell them, "Well, what's the problem? I mean, you said you spent $3,000 last month on SEO. I'm asking for a thirtieth of that to gain your company money. A hundred dollars. If you spend $3,000 on SEO, then you definitely have the money to do it."

And then they're probably gonna open up with you and say something like, "Well, I just don't believe this really works." Or "Well, I just don't know your company, and I've been ripped off before." And your first thought is to get defensive that they're calling you a scammer. No. They're not. They don't know you. They don't have any reason to trust you. They're giving you the opportunity, right now, to stop and build that trust and get that sale.

So, they don't trust you, they say. They're worried. You go, "Whoa. Well, you know what? I understand that. There's a lot of shady companies out here. Let me show you our reviews and testimonials

we've gotten from the businesses we've worked with." You show them every business you've worked with is now making more money month after month. How hard do you think it's gonna be to convince them to sign up for an audit when you can show them every single person you worked with is now making more money? Every single person you worked with wrote a review for you. And they gave you 4 to 5 stars every single time without fail. There is not one bad review in there.

These people are gonna go from "I don't really know who your company is" to "Please, please will you work with me. Please help my company make money." And if you had practiced the old way of sales, you would have never got here. What you would have done would have been agitating, badgering them until they hung up on you or left you hanging. But listen, process, and respond definitely got you the sale here. I mean, your response to ask them, "Okay, it's not the money. So what's the real problem?" There's nothing wrong with that. You're just carrying on a conversation.

Now if you come out arrogant, like a salesman would "Well, I know you have the money. Look at all this money you make. You should be able to afford the $299 audit people have this mindset that just because a place is a business, they should be able to pay 2, 3, 4 times what normal people pay for stuff. And that's not right. They're doing business because they're smart with their money, not because they just give it to people for no reason. So, if you take this old sales path, you

can end up with the old sales path results. On to the next client, no sale, no happy customer, and they probably won't talk to you again.

Or you can change the game up just a little bit, start touching people on a human level, and start creating real partnerships. Real relationships with your customers. Relationships where when you call next time, they're gonna be happy to hear from you because the last time they talked to you, you made them a bunch of money.

Section 6: Practice Exercise, What Do They Really Mean?

WHAT THEY SAY:

- "It's too expensive."
- "I need to think about it."
- "I'm happy with my current provider."
- "Send me some information first."
- "I don't have time to deal with this right now."

Now go to the next section labeled "What They Really Mean" and write what you think each objection means.

What They Really Mean:

1._____

2._____

3._____

4._____

5._____

Don't turn the page until you've filled out all 5 questions.

ANSWER SHEET: What They Really Could Have Meant

1. "It's too expensive."

Could really mean: I'm not sure about your company. I don't see the value yet.

How the conversation can go: "Well, I'm sure you spend thousands of dollars a month on business expenses, and this is only $100. So, I'm not sure if you really mean it's too expensive, or if you're saying you don't have belief in the company. And if it's the belief in the company, then by all means, let me show you the work we're doing with other businesses in your area. And I'm sure once you see the results we're getting, that $100 won't be too expensive."

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2. "I need to think about it."

Could really mean: I've been very busy, and I don't have mental space left.

How the conversation can go: "Well, I understand that you want to think about it. If someone handed you a bag of money and said, 'Do you want this?' would you need to think about it? I don't think the real problem is time to think, I think you're overwhelmed. But here's the good news: you don't need to spend any extra time on this. All I

need is your URL, your name, your number, and your email. Give me 5 minutes, and you're done. Then you go back to running your business while we fix your visibility problem. So what's your URL?"

---

3. "I'm happy with my current provider."

Could really mean: I'm afraid of change, even if my current solution isn't perfect.
How the conversation can go:
"Just so you know, we're not trying to replace your current provider. We're happy to work hand-in-hand with them. Whatever they're doing now, our work will only add to it. And we're charging far less. You don't need to get rid of anyone just strengthen what's already working."

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4. "Send me some information first."

Could really mean: I don't know enough about you yet. This is a delay tactic.

How the conversation can go: "Do you have a specific reason you need information? Because anything you need answered, I can answer right now. Instead of waiting two weeks for something in the mail, ask me your questions right here. I'll give you every answer you need on the spot so you can see the value immediately."

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5. "I don't have time to deal with this right now."

Could really mean: In rare cases it's legitimate but most of the time it's hesitation or uncertainty.

How the conversation can go: "In some industries, sure lawyers, medical professionals they might really be swamped. But most of the time, it's a delay tactic. So, you ask gently: 'You don't have time to hear how to make more money?' That opens the door. Then explain: 'Your part takes 5 minutes. Answer a few questions, make your payment, and you're done. The rest is on me. You go back to your day, and I go to work making you money.'"

Section 7: Objections as Encouragement

Here's what changed everything for me: When you look at it from this frame of mind, objections are just encouragement. You gotta change how you think about sales. Most people hear objections as rejection. As criticism. As failure. As a reason to give up. But I learned to hear them as encouragement. As guidance. As "Come on, solve this buddy, you can do it." As information about what they actually need. When someone says "I don't have time" for the third time, you don't get frustrated or give up. You think, "Great! They're still helping me figure out the real puzzle."

That reframe changes everything. When you hear "I don't have time" or "It's too expensive" or "I need to think about it," you stop taking it personally. You start seeing it as collaborative problem-solving. The customer isn't your opponent, they're your partner in finding the right solution.

Section 8: They Haven't Ended the Conversation

Here's something crucial: If they're still talking to you, they're still giving you another chance. They're saying, "Come on. Solve this, buddy. You can do it." So, if they say, "I don't have time," and you say, "Well, here's what this process can do for you," and they say, "Yeah. I'm sorry. I still don't have the time. First, realize they haven't ended the conversation. They're still giving you another chance. Maybe you finally say, "Oh, you know what? That's great. You don't have the time, but you're not the one that must do the audit. I'll do it. You don't need the time. You can spend the time doing what you need to do run your business. And I will handle the audit. You don't have to worry about it." Maybe that's what it is. They wanna know, "I really can't be involved with this. I'm so busy." And you're giving them permission to spend their time running their business while you handle the audit.

Closing

In closing, the LPR Listen, Process, Respond framework is all about being a detective, not a debater. It takes old-school sales tactics, throws them out the window, and it turns you into a human being with emotions. You're gonna be like Sherlock Holmes trying to figure out all these little puzzles. And now that you have the framework, the rest of the book will move you on to how it can be used with specific

objections. So now that we've pounded that framework into you listen, process, respond, listen, process, respond you're getting away from being a script and moving towards being a human being and reacting dynamically to what these people say to you. When they say something to you, you listen. You think it through. You respond.

And they're gonna see the difference between you and people that used to do sales. They're gonna see the difference, and that's only going to help you. I mean, first, they're gonna see right away, "Hey, this person's treating me like a human being. Maybe this guy is not even a salesman." They're going to be wondering what you do for a living. Because they've never had a salesman treat them so great. When you have that framework Listen, Process, Respond and when you see objections as encouragement instead of rejection, everything changes.

CHAPTER 4

It's Too Expensive

Opening

"It's too expensive." That's probably the most common objection you'll ever hear in sales. And here's what most salespeople do when they hear it: they either defend their price, offer a discount, or try to justify why their service is worth the money. All those responses are wrong. Because here's what I've learned: when someone says, "it's too expensive," 90% of the time, it's about everything but price. Let me tell you a story that'll prove it.

Section 1: The Southern Tier Pumpkin Beer

When I worked at a beer distributor, every Halloween we'd get Southern Tier pumpkin beer in stock. This stuff was premium probably $60, $70, maybe $80 a case. And this was ten years ago, so that was expensive. Every single person that came in to buy it would complain about the price.

Every single one. "Wow, that's so expensive." "Man, that's a lot of money for beer." "I can't believe how much these cost."

And you know what? Every single person that complained left with a case of Southern Tier pumpkin in their cart. Every. Single. Time. They weren't saying it was too expensive. They were saying something else entirely.

Section 2: What "Too Expensive" Really Means

So, what were they really saying when they grumbled about that $70–$80 price tag? Maybe they were saying, "This better be worth it for that price." Maybe they were saying, "My wife is gonna be pissed at me for spending $80 on a case of beer." Maybe they were saying, "I got this a couple of years ago at another beer distributor, and it tasted really bad. "But here's the thing: they were embarrassed to say those things out loud. "My wife's gonna be mad at me" makes you sound weak. "I got burned before" makes you sound gullible.

So instead, they used price as the label. Because price was the easy thing to complain about. It's socially acceptable. Nobody judges you for being price conscious. But they might judge you for admitting you're afraid of your spouse or that you made a bad decision in the past.

Section 3: The Four Types of "Too Expensive"

When someone says, "it's too expensive," they're usually telling you one of four different things. And each one needs a different response.

Type 1: Can't Afford It (Genuine Budget Constraint)

This might seem like a real budget issue. But here's the point: you gotta look at what you're gonna spend versus the return you're going to get. You're gonna spend maybe $99, but you know that one customer you gain by getting recommended by AI is gonna bring in more than that. Easily, one customer is gonna bring in more than $100. So "I can't afford it," while it may be a genuine concern, is something that should be easily overcome when you show the returns they'll gain.

Type 2: Not Worth It (Value Perception Problem)

"Not worth it" isn't saying they don't have the money. That's a whole different objection. That's usually them saying, "I'm not sure the value of what you're gonna offer me is worth me buying the product." And how you overcome that is by showing them testimonials from other customers, showing them the return that you've gained for other customers. Show them the reviews you've gotten from other customers. So, you can build up your value, and they can see what you're really worth.

Because what they're saying what they aren't saying is "I don't like you, I don't trust you, I don't believe you." What they're saying is "I don't know you. I have nothing to base handing you my money on." So, you must make it enticing enough. You must show them your value.

And really, the only way to show them your value is by your past work and past customers. That is the best way to show them, "I'm worth the product I'm selling. Here's the proof. Go ask these other businesses. I'd be happy for you to call them. See what we did for them." That's how you build up your value in their eyes for the "it might not be worth it" value perception problem.

Type 3: Wrong Timing (Cash Flow Issue)

When you're working with "wrong timing," which is usually a cash flow issue let's be honest. When is there a good time to spend money? There really isn't a good time to spend money.
But honestly, a good time to spend money is right now. Spend this $100 and get your name out to these AI bots. The time is right now because the faster you get this done, the faster they're gonna start recommending you to people, and the faster you're gonna see that money coming back to you.

Instinctively, it might seem like a bad time. I get that. But there's no better time than right now to fix your problem, start getting yourself recommended, and start upping the money you're bringing in, upping the customers you're bringing in every month.

Type 4: Need Approval (Authority Issue Disguised as Price)

"Need approval" is more of an authority issue disguised as a price issue. They might feel like they need to speak to their better half or co-owners, but I mean, first of all, if you're talking to the business owner, who else besides you can make a decision on your business? Or you could tell them, "Hey. You know what? I have a great idea. Why don't we get your partner on the phone? We'll talk to him right now.

Call him up. Let's tell him what I have to offer. If we don't call them now, you never know. You might go home, talk to him, call me tomorrow, and I've got 10 people lined up in front of you. So your best bet is to call them, let us talk to them, and that will overcome the objection if you're just saying it to delay."

Then they're gonna say, "Well, there's nobody I really need to call." And then you can talk to them, and then you can go through it with them. And if they really do have someone they have to talk to, that works out fine because you can get them on the phone. You're done with this. Let's get this handled. Let's get it out of the way. You wanna bring someone else in? Let's do it. Bring them in.

Section 4: What They Really Needed

You know what those beer customers really needed? They needed permission. They needed someone to say, "Sure, buddy. I'll give you permission to buy this beer." I mean; I didn't actually say that to most people. But with some customers I knew personally, when they'd start complaining about the price, I'd say, "Hey. Alright. What's wrong? You afraid the old lady's gonna knock you in the head for this?"

And you know what? A lot of times they'd chuckle. Because I hit that nail right on the head. I knew that's exactly what the problem was. Then we'd have a little laugh about it, they'd buy the beer, and they'd go on their way. Next year, they'll be back, and we'd go through the same thing. They didn't need me to lower the price. They needed me to give them permission to feel okay about spending the money.

Section 5: When Price Complaints Are Really About Your Business

Now let's talk about what this means for your business. When someone says your service is too expensive, they don't really mean it's too expensive. They spend much more than $99 or $299 a month on other business expenses. If you don't believe me, just look at what they spent last year on SEO. They probably got a website, and they pay a website company every month to maintain it. They probably have software for their business, and they probably pay a huge price for that software.

They're not saying it's too expensive. They're saying, "I need to know it's worth it." They're willing to pay. But they just need to know it's worth it. So, what you need to let them know is: "I know $100 seems expensive but think about the money that you're missing because you're not getting recommendations. That's a lot more than $100. So, you're actually spending more money by not having the service than if you got it."

Section 6: Qualifying Questions to Uncover the Real Objection

When the pricing complaints are really about your business, there are a few qualifying questions we can ask to really get to the heart of the matter. These qualifying questions uncover the real objection besides "it just costs too much."

Question 1: "What did you spend on marketing last month?"

Ask, "What did you spend on marketing last month?" And then you find out they spent $2,000–$3,000 on marketing, another few thousand on SEO. That's when you know, okay, this isn't about price. You know they're already spending a ton. So the objection isn't about price. The objection comes around something else, like "I don't trust your business. I really don't know you. I'm scared maybe the service isn't worth it" all the stuff that we went over. And you know how to

overcome that stuff. It's not hard to overcome that stuff once you figure out what it is.

So that's the first qualifying question: "What did you spend on marketing last month?" Just ask them that, and then you fall back on your routine: Listen, Process, Respond. And after you do that, you know how to answer them.

Question 2: "How much does each new customer bring you?"

Second qualifying question is, "Well, how much does each new customer bring you?" I mean, if each new customer is bringing them $2,000–$3,000, and they're spending $100 to get that new customer, then it's a no-brainer. Just a ballpark. Just a ballpark figure. "Oh, well, with each new customer, it's about $4,000." Okay. So, what you're telling me is spending $100 it isn't worth you spending $100 to get a $4,000 customer?

And that's when they really will start to think about it. And that's where the real objections will come out if they have any real objections. Or maybe they say, "You know what? That's true." Think about that trade-off. $100 for $4,000. Who's not gonna make that trade every single time? I'll give you $100 right now if there's a potential that you're gonna hand me $3,000–$4,000 back. So, the second qualifying question handles it just by asking them how much each new customer brings them.

Question 3: "What's the cost of not being visible right now?"

Our third and last qualifying question would be, "What's the cost of not being visible right now?" And that's a good question for them to answer. What are you costing your business by not being recommended by AI bots? I mean, how many people pick up their phone and ask for business in your industry? And I mean, let's go even deeper. Let's think about tourist areas Ocean City, Myrtle Beach, all those tourist areas. Those businesses live and die off people's recommendations. Every single chatbot says, "Yeah. Go to Dave's restaurant in Myrtle Beach" equates into straight money for them. And if they don't get those recommendations, they can't stay in business.

So, while to some people, this might just be, "Oh, I get recommended or I don't get recommended, I'll deal with it," honestly, to some businesses, this is the difference between keeping their doors open or sending their employees home and saying, "I'm sorry. We don't make enough money to employ you anymore." That's how serious this is. So, I mean, think ask yourself: Are you willing to tell your employees, "We're sorry. We don't have enough business.
We have to get rid of you. Why? Well, yeah, this guy came through and he was selling these audits, so we would get recommended by AI. It was $100, so we just decided not to do it." What are you telling your employee? Are you telling your employees they're not worth $100 to

get more business in there so you can make more money for your business, and you can make more money to pay them so they can feed their family?
Because I'm telling you now, your employee is worth $100. And keeping your business alive is worth $100.

Section 7: The Integrity of Your Pricing

Here's something else and this is like a bonus tip. Think about this: They tell you it's too expensive. And you say, "Okay. Well, I'll do it for $79." They say, "Oh, no. Yeah, you know, I'm not gonna " So you say, "Well, I'll do it for $59." What you're telling them is the service wasn't worth $100 to begin with. So now you drove a wedge in there, and in their mind, they know this service is not worth it to them. If you're willing to just drop your prices like that and do it for anything, then the value wasn't real.

If I talk to 100 people and I get 100 no's, I know my audit's still worth $99. And I'm not gonna lower that. You have more chance of closing the sale by not lowering the price than you do if you lower it. Because if you lower it, you just told them it wasn't worth $100 to begin with.

Section 8: Price Your Service Fairly

Now, here's the thing. Make sure you're pricing your service fairly. Don't go overinflating. Don't say, "Oh, I'll do an audit for $3,000 a month" just because "this is a business, they have money to spend."

But what you gotta realize is businesses that are doing good and that's why you're talking to them, because they're making money, they're a business businesses that do good are careful with their money. They're not just going to throw money out there at you.

We don't make our price based on what we think we could pull out of a company. We make our price based on what we think would be a great value to the company and still leave them with something in the bank. I mean, these SEO companies literally charge like $2,500, $3,000 a month. And people pay it.
But we're literally, at our high end, 10 times cheaper. Even at our $299 premium service, we're 10 times cheaper than what SEO companies are charging for outdated technology.

Section 9: The Value Reframe

Here's my favorite response to the price objection. When someone tries to negotiate me down, I flip it on them:
"You know what? If I'm bringing you in a $5,000 client, maybe $99 isn't the right price. Maybe we should make $1,000. Because then you're still getting an 80% return." Tell you what, you say that, and I bet you $99 looks attractive all of a sudden.
You see what I did there? I anchored them to higher value instead of lower price. Now they're thinking about the $4,000 profit they're making, not the $99 investment. And $99 feels like I'm practically giving it away compared to the $1,000 "fair market rate."

Closing

Here's the bottom line: Don't ever worry about the price. As long as you're confident that you have a good service and a good price, don't ever worry about the price. Your price point is set when you walk into that meeting. The only thing that changes are the excuses why they don't wanna buy. You gotta figure out what those real excuses are. Not the price point. Price point is set. And don't ever let yourself get into the trap where you take less. Say you walk in, give somebody the presentation, and they say, "Well, if you'll do it for $50, I'll get it."
You know what you say? "You will do it for $50? Awesome. Then you'll do it for $99 too. I mean, you won't do it for $99?"
And when they can't answer that logically, you say, "Alright, sir. Well, hey. You have a great day, and thanks for meeting with me, buddy. Take care." No anger. No desperation. No begging. Just professional respect for your own value and a polite goodbye.

Because here's the thing: You get them a customer that makes them $5,000 because they're showing up in the AI searches all of a sudden. They're still gonna get $5,000 off that customer, whether they paid $99 or whether they paid $50. It isn't like, "Okay, I'll do it for $50. Okay, well, then I'll get you a customer that can spend $2,500." The value you deliver doesn't change based on what they pay you. So why should your price change based on how much they complain? It shouldn't. And it won't. Not if you know your worth.

CHAPTER 5

I Need To Think About It

Opening

"I need to think about it." When you hear those words, what you're really hearing is: "I don't want to be pinned down with a decision right this second."

Now, I'm kind of a strange individual. You know, when I say I need to think about it, it really means I need to think about it. But for most people? It's just a stall tactic. And they're really saying, "I don't want to be pinned down with a decision right this second." Let me show you what I mean.

Section 1: The Furniture Store Reality

You go into a furniture store. You want to buy furniture. You know you're there to buy furniture. And you find the furniture you want. The salesman's like, "Let's get you rung up." And you're like, "Well, I need to think about it." What do you need to think about? Didn't you come to the store to buy furniture?

"Well, yeah." Well, then what do you need to think about? I mean, you either have the money or you don't. So, what do you need to think about?

It makes no sense. If you go out and you're just out there tire-kicking, why tell the salesman "I need to think about it"? Maybe when you meet up with the salesman the very first time, you say, "Hey, bud. I'm out here tire-kicking. Not sure if I'm buying anything. So, I'm just gonna be honest with you. Might not get anything. I came out to tire-kick." These transactions would move so much easier. You know, a salesman would probably let up off on that pressure a little bit. "Well, he's not sure if he really even wants to buy, so I'm gonna let him go ahead and look around. And if he wants something, we'll deal with that at that point." Make it easier for everybody.

Section 2: What "I Need to Think About It" Really Means

In a small percentage of cases, "I need to think about it" means "I need to gather more information." In another small percentage, it means "I need to talk to my wife about this." But let's be honest: if you're coming to buy furniture, chances are you brought your wife with you. Or you were just out there tire-kicking. You weren't there to make a serious purchase in the beginning. Maybe you're just out tire-kicking. Most of the time, "I need to think about it" is really one of these: "This feels too fast."

- "I want to feel in control of the timing."
- "I'm scared of making the wrong choice."
- "I don't want to feel pressured."
- "I want to escape this sales situation."

Section 3: The Psychology Behind Stalling

Let's dig into why humans default to "I need time" when they're pressured with sales.

The Fight-Flight-Freeze Response

The first part of the psychology of stalling is that trying to sell somebody something puts them into an automatic fight-or-flight response. And that's your mind's normal way of basically protecting itself in dangerous situations. But here's what they don't realize: Sales aren't a dangerous situation, but your mind goes there anyway. It's easier to freeze and say "I need time" than just hang up on someone. It's more socially acceptable to say, "I need time."

Plus, "I need time" gives control back to that person. They're saying, "I feel like you're taking control from me, and I'm going to gain it back by saying I need time." Now the ball's back in their court. It's no longer them being pressured to give a decision. They've given their decision: "I need time." That's why "I need time to think" is people's biggest comeback.

The Control Issue

Number 2 revolves around control. When you ask somebody for a decision, they feel like you're taking control from them saying, "Hey, I need time," gives them back a sense of agency. It makes them feel

like they are now in control. Now they're not the ones being pressured. They've given their answer, and now you have to respond if they need time. It puts the ball back in their court. But then maybe press them a little further: "Okay. What do you need time for? What do you need time to decide?"

Let's talk about this. I mean, like I've said before in the book, there's nothing I can't answer right here on the phone right now for you that you couldn't wait 2 days, 3 days to hear. So, tell me what you need time to think about, and we'll handle it. If you need time, I'll give you the time. That's fine. But if you're just saying, "I need time" because you're not sure of the situation, then say, "I'm just not sure of the situation," and we'll handle it.

Social Conditioning

Number 3 is social conditioning. Let's be honest. We've all been taught that you need to sit down and think about any big decision. Well, yeah, maybe for a big decision, you do. My grandfather always told me he was a big salesman for IBM and he always told me before you make any decision, think on it for 24 hours. But a decision for a $100 audit? Maybe you don't need to think about it for 24 hours. A decision of "Should I buy this home or not?" By all means, think about it for 24 hours.

I mean, with the social conditioning, we're taught that if you say yes, you're being reckless. And if you say, "Hey, I need some time," you

know, that's the socially responsible person in you speaking. But that's not really true. We don't need to wait 24 hours for these small decisions, especially when they can bring in money. It can help my employees. Why on earth would I tell them I wanna think about it when I see the benefits that it's gonna bring me? I should literally say, "Sign me up. Sign me up."

Avoiding Regret

Unfortunately, people worry more about buyers' remorse. They're more worried about buyers' remorse than they are about getting a new product or a new system that could actually help them. They're more worried about buying something and afterwards being burned than buying something that works and then making money. The fear of losing overcomes the fear of winning. They're twice as afraid of losing as they are excited about winning.

Analysis Paralysis

Last, we meet your enemy: inaction. Analysis paralysis. Basically, what analysis paralysis is the brain always wants to gather more information so it can make the perfect decision.

But at some point, no amount of information is gonna help them make a better decision. But they feel like the more they study up on it, the more information they get, the better off they're gonna be. And it literally stops them from deciding.

Sometimes what you must do is just look at your decision in black and white.

"I'm looking at this AIO audit. What's it going to do? It's gonna give me my problems with my website so I can be visible to AI bots, so they can recommend me to more people, in return gaining more money." And you need to keep it in very black and white terms to make this decision. So when you see, okay, it's going to do this for me. It's gonna do this for me. It's going to do this for me, which in turn is gonna do this for me, and it's plus, plus, plus, plus, plus… what are you still thinking about it for? Four or five pluses against a $100 selling fee?
Why are you still thinking about it? Do what you know is good for your business. If for some reason it doesn't work out, you deal with it afterwards. You lost $100. Deal with it afterwards. But it works.

Section 4: Breaking Down the Stall

When someone says, "I need to think about it," say, "Okay. What do you wanna think about? Do you want furniture?" "Well, yeah. I wanna get furniture." "Okay. Great. Do you have some money to pay for the furniture?" "Well, yeah. Yeah, I can pay for the furniture." "What else is there to think about? Do you want it in white? Do you want it in black? Let's go." That's it. You just stripped away all the stalling and got to the actual decision points:

- Do you want the product? ✓

- Can you afford it? ✓
- What specific choices need to be made? (Color, size, etc.)

Those are the only real decisions. Everything else is emotional processing or stall tactics. And, I mean, that's the same in every single industry. Housing, automobile… that will apply to everything.

Section 5: Real Conversation Examples

Let me show you how this works in real Algorithm Collective calls.

Call #1: The Value Perception Problem

- **Me:** "So the AIO audit is $99, and we'll have your business showing up in AI recommendations within 48 hours."
- **Client**: "Well, this sounds interesting, but I need to think about it. This is a big decision for my business."
- **Me:** "Sure. I understand you wanna think about it. I mean, any business decision, you think about. But you mentioned this is a big business decision, and I'm not sure that $100 will qualify as a big business decision. I mean, would you mind sharing with me how much you spent on marketing last month?"
- **Client:** "Well, we spent about $2,500 last month on SEO and another $1,000 on Google Ads. But that's different we know those work."

- **Me:** "Well, you know those work, but you also see the price: $3,500. That is literally 35 times more expensive than what I'm offering to do for you, which is basically the same thing get your company up and recommended by AI. SEO, unfortunately, is going the way of the dinosaur at this point. Most people aren't picking up their phone, typing in Google. Most people are picking up their phone saying, 'Hey, Claude. Hey, ChatGPT. Can you give me a restaurant?' And in fact, they're not just asking for restaurants. They're qualifying their questions. 'Can you recommend a restaurant that serves sushi within 10 miles?' This isn't any more of that 'Hey, just give me a business in a 50-mile radius and I'm gonna use them.'"
- **Client:** "I guess I hadn't really thought about that. People do use ChatGPT and those AI things more now. But how do I know this works? I mean, SEO companies show me reports and rankings…"
- **Me:** "Oh, I mean, that's easy. First, we'll give you a list of clients you can talk to where we have made significant changes in their company. And it's all because of what we've done for them. They're now earning more money. They're getting more customers. And second, with AI, you can check for yourself. You can go to AI and say, 'Hey, can you recommend me a restaurant around here?' And when they say your name, you know what? You can just call and thank me then."
- **Client:** "Okay, that makes sense. I could test it myself right after we do this. And if your other clients are making more

money… alright, you know what? Let's do it. What do you need from me?"

Call #2: The Authority Issue

- **Me:** "So for $99, we'll audit your AI visibility and get you showing up in ChatGPT and Claude recommendations."
- **Client:** "Hmm, I need to think about it. Let me talk to my business partner first and get back to you."
- **Me:** "Oh, yeah. I get it. You want to talk to your partner. You know what? Why don't you give him a call on the phone real quick? All three of us can go through this. I can answer any questions he has and get you guys signed up and on your way."
- **Client:** "Oh, well, he's actually not available right now. He's in meetings all day. I really should wait to talk to him first before making any decisions like this."
- **Me:** "Well, I understand. He sounds like he's pretty busy and a pretty important part of the business, but I think it would go all the better if we can work this out between us."
- **Client:** "Well, I mean, we always make marketing decisions together. It's just how we do business. I can't really go around him on this…"
- **Me:** "I get that. And, you know, here's the deal I'll make you. We'll go ahead. We'll sign you up. I'll start the audit tonight. You go home. You talk to him. And if this is something that he's dead set against, tell him to give me a call. I'll give you

your money back. No harm done. Nothing lost. We all win in the end."

- **Client:** "You know what? That's really fair. If you're willing to give me my money back if he's not on board, then yeah, let's do it. What information do you need from me?"

Call #3: Multiple Objections

- **Me:** "The AIO audit is $99, and we'll have results for you within 48 hours showing exactly how to get your business recommended by AI."
- **Client:** "This is interesting, but I really need to think about it. There's just a lot going on with the business right now, and I'm not sure this is the right timing."
- **Me:** "Well, I understand. You sound like you're busy now. You know? Here's the good news. I'll give you the good news right off the bat. There's nothing you really must do. Besides giving me your business name, your URL, and the payment, there's nothing else you must do. You can go back to doing what you're good at, which is running your business and making money. And I'll do what I'm good at, which is auditing your business, getting you seen by AI, and making you money."
- **Client:** "Well, that does sound pretty hands-off. But I'm still not sure about the timing. We have just invested a lot in a new website redesign, and we're waiting to see how that performs

before we add anything else. Plus, our budget is pretty tight this quarter after that expense."

- **Me:** "Oh, my God. Let me stop you right there. You just finished your website. Your timing is literally perfect because you have a brand new website that we can fine-tune to run in tandem with these AI bots. There's literally not a better time than somebody that just finished a website. It's a fresh website. We know what these websites gotta look like and gotta have to be picked up by the AI chatbots. And the price I guarantee you the price is probably one-tenth to one-twenty-fifth at least less than you paid on the website. I mean, you're looking at $100. I guarantee that website build was over $100. Can you give me that? Yes or no? Was that website more than $100?"
- **Client:** "Well, yeah, the website was about $8,000. But that's exactly why I'm hesitant we just spent all that money, and now you're telling me we need to spend more to make it work with AI?"
- **Me:** "Okay. You know what? First, this isn't taking over your new investment. This is adding to it. This is making your new investment even stronger. I mean, if you're that worried about the money, and since we're only charging you $100 one time, not $100 a month a $100 one time, maybe one month you can skip that SEO payment. Maybe one month, you could drop something else that's costing you two or three thousand a

month, just to make this $100 one-time payment to make sure your website is running on all cylinders."

- **Client:** "You know what? When you put it like that… we do spend $2,500 a month on SEO, and if this is just $100 one time to make our new $8,000 website work better with AI… that actually makes a lot of sense. And you're right, the timing is perfect since we just finished the site. Alright, let's do it. What do you need from me?"

Section 6: The Universal Challenge

When they challenge you with "I need to think about it," you challenge them back. "Let's think about it right here. You're here. Right? Won't hurt to think about it." If they really need to "think about it," then let's do the thinking together right now with all the information available. Most people can't come up with a good answer to "What exactly do you need to think about that we can't think about right here?" That's when the real objection comes out:

- "I feel pressured."
- "I want to compare prices elsewhere."
- "I'm not really ready to buy today."
- "My spouse will kill me if I don't check with them first."

Now you can address their actual concern instead of just accepting the stall and losing the sale.

Section 7: The 24-Hour Rule Trap

So, the 24-hour rule basically says, you know, most sales leaders say if they say they want time to think about it, to go ahead and give them the time and call them back in 24 hours. But while we are big on our approach to not badger people, just after them saying "I need 24 hours," just saying, "Okay, I'll call you tomorrow" it's really gonna hurt you.

I mean, in those 24 hours, their excitement over the whole process fades. You know, in those 24 hours, the closing rate drops from 70% down to 10%. There is nothing good about letting them leave. So, when they first approach you and say, "Hey, I need 24 hours to think about this," you must give them a little bit of pushback. It doesn't have to be the old traditional sales pushback where you have them crying on the phone, you know? But what it could be is as simple as, "Well, what do you need 24 hours to think about? Let's think about it right now. What's the problem?"

And let them tell you what the thing holding them back is.
Because most of the time, if you press them that little bit, they'll come up with a real answer that you can identify. You know, they might say, "Hey, I don't really know you or your company." Or, "I really don't have a lot of time to go through all this." Whatever their answer is. When they answer that question "What do you want 24 hours to think about?" they give you a chance to solve that puzzle that they bring to you. "I don't really know your company." Well, you know what? Let me show you, our company. "Well, I just don't have time right now."

Oh, perfect. Because we don't need you to do anything. You'll literally pay for it, give me the answer to 3 or 4 questions, and you're out of the process. "Well, I don't really have a lot of money right now." Well, you know what? That works. We don't really charge a lot compared to every other industry out there.

Section 8: Stop Treating Customers Like Medieval Executioners

Here's the thing: Stop looking at customers like they're medieval executioners. They're just a person like me and you. You're doing a job. They came to your place of work. Treat them like human beings. They're not up on a pedestal. I appreciate treating them like normal human beings instead of making this whole interaction weird. When you approach it with that human-to-human respect, "Let's think about it right here" becomes a helpful suggestion, not pressure. You're treating them like an intelligent person who can work through decisions. You're not being weird or overly deferential. You're just two adults having a normal conversation about a purchase.

Section 9: When They Weren't Buying Anyway

And here's something else. If they didn't really come to buy, and you put that pressure on, they're probably gonna turn around and leave. And if they turn around and leave, chances are they were never

buying. It doesn't matter who showed up to help them. It doesn't matter what your inventory was. They probably weren't buying in the first place. And what you wanna do when you get a customer that's probably not buying in the first place is process them and get on to a customer that probably is buying.

Here's the bottom line: From time to time, you're gonna get that person that is just coming in to show how good he is at negotiating, and he's not planning on buying anything anyways. Don't waste your energy. Don't waste your time. Because the end result is you getting upset, you are getting frustrated. You're wasting your time while the other salesmen are working with people that are there to buy. When you get that customer you know, Mister Negotiations and he's not there to buy, send him on his way and start talking to somebody that's there to buy.

Section 10: The Absurdity Check

I mean, who needs time to think about making more money? You know? That doesn't make sense. Think of it like this: If I came up to you and said, "Hey. Do you wanna make more money?" There's not a chance in hell you would ever say, "You know what? Let me think about that." Nope. You wanna make money? Sign me up. So, when someone says "I need to think about it" to your pitch about helping their business grow, what they're really saying is:

- "I don't believe you can actually make me more money."

- "This sounds too good to be true."
- "I'm skeptical this will work."
- "Prove to me this isn't a waste of money."

But "I need to think about it" feels safer than "I think you're probably lying about the results."

Closing

"I need to think about it" is almost never about needing time. It's about needing something else confidence, trust, value proof, or just permission to escape the conversation. Your job is to figure out which one it is. Call out the stall tactic respectfully: "What exactly do you need to think about that we can't address right now?" If they give you a real answer, you can solve the real problem. If they can't articulate what they need to think about, they're probably not serious buyers anyway.

Don't waste time on people who were never going to buy. Process them quickly and move on to customers who want help making good decisions. Because at the end of the day, nobody needs time to think about whether they want more revenue for their business. The only question is whether they believe your solution will deliver it. And if they don't believe it yet, no amount of "thinking about it" alone in their office is going to change that. But a real conversation with you right now might.

CHAPTER 6

I'm Happy With My Current Provider

Opening

"I'm happy with my current provider." When someone tells you this, they're almost never telling you the truth. I know, because I've used this line a ton of times myself. When cable companies come to me almost every single time I tell someone I'm happy with my current provider, it just means I'm afraid to change. People come to me and say, "Hey, we have Cable Company, and we wanna tell you what our rates are." And I say, "I'm happy with my current provider. Trust me." But I know I'm not. I'm complaining every month about how this cable company is charging me all this money. There's never anything good on TV. But as soon as somebody asks me, I'm "happy with my current provider." Why? Because I'm afraid to change.

Section 1: The Fear Behind Loyalty

Almost every single time I tell someone I'm happy with my current provider, it just means I'm afraid to change. What if I make the switch and end up worse off? At least I know what problems I have now. The devil you know is better than the devil you don't. So "I'm happy with my current provider" really means:

- "Change feels risky and complicated."
- "What if the new provider is worse?"
- "I don't want to deal with switching hassles."
- "I'm comfortable with predictable problems."

Section 2: "The Devil You Know" Psychology

I used to think like everybody else. I used to wonder why people would be in abusive relationships and they wouldn't leave. I never understood. It didn't make sense. Why won't they just leave? I never understood the whole "devil you know" psychology until it happened to me. My wife passed away, and I had started dating a lady a few months after that, like six months, eight months after that. When I first met her, everyone puts up their best front. They hide all the psychological stuff they have going on, and none of that comes to the surface. But after a few months of knowing her, after she had moved in with me, it quickly went downhill fast. The physical abuse started. The psychological abuse started. I mean, it was unbelievable.

And, you know, asking her to leave was the furthest thing in my mind. I felt like I was responsible for her. Everyone around me is telling me, "Bro, she's no good. Bro, this, that, the other." And me, I'm trying to stand up for myself because I don't wanna look bad. So, I'm telling them, "Oh, no. She's not that bad. She's not that bad." But I knew how bad she was. I knew how toxic she was. And it literally comes down to the devil you know. It's easier to deal with than the devil you don't know. And I'll tell you what, she was honestly the devil I knew. I mean, she put her hands on me like she was a grown man in a hockey game. She would literally try to fight me.

Unfortunately, my mom even mentioned this to me. She said she felt horrible because she had taught me to never put my hands on a woman, and she never added, "but keep yourself safe over and above everything else." She said, "I've taught you, 'never put your hands on a woman,' but I feel horrible because I never taught you to keep yourself safe over and above everything else." And she's right. She never taught me that. It was: "Don't put your hands on a woman under any circumstances." And I didn't. And I probably never will. That's just how I'm built.

But Kelly would punch me, hit me, you know, all that shit. And I would basically just push her away or back her off whatever I could do to get away from her safely without having to put hands on her. And there I was, stuck in it, until one day she did something that put my kids in danger. I mean, they were grown at the time they were 24

years old, 20 years old, 19, something around there but she did something that put their lives in danger. And that ended that minute. That was literally the last time I saw her, ever, because I've always been of the idea: you can do whatever you want to me, but you cannot put my fucking kids in danger under any circumstances. When she did that, it was done.

Let me give you another situation I'm currently in now, but I'm in the midst of breaking this cycle. I work for a machining company. I worked there in the machine shop with two other people we can call them John and Chuck. John was a great guy. Towards the end, he decided to retire. He had been there 47 years. That was exactly the number of years I had been alive. But he had worked there for 47 years and was ready to retire. So, they brought in someone and we were training him, and he didn't work out. Then they brought someone else in, and I told Bob, "Look, Bob. You tried Rick. He didn't work out. Give me a chance, man. I'm asking for two weeks. Let Ronnie train me for two weeks. If he says I can pick it up, go with me. If not, I'll go back to being a manual machinist, and I won't bug you again. If I can't pick it up, then I can't pick it up."

So, he says, "Okay. I'll let John train you for two weeks." Well, John trained me for two, three weeks, and next thing you know, I'm running the machine. So, in my head, that means John vouched for me. So, we're working. They bring in a new kid named Jake. And, you know, we go from "Don't ever run that machine without John being

there" to "We want you to train Jake." Okay. That's a quick change. I went from doing only manual work, never touching the CNC machine, to being responsible for all cases between 5 inches and 13, 14 inches. So, I just ran with it. I picked up that fucking ball and I ran with it. And I did great.

I go in the office a year later at raise time and they're telling me, "Hey. You're doing a phenomenal job. Just keep it up. You fell into John 's shoes, and you did great. And you've been doing great ever since." And I'm like, "Well, shit. Okay." So, of course, Jake doesn't work out. He leaves. They get rid of him. It's only been me and Chuck. Now we have a problem because when John was there, all Chuck had to do was make his little 2, 3, 4-inch cases, and that was it. I had to do all the manual work. Ronnie did the other cases. So, I went to Bob and said, "Bob, let me ask you. Am I the one responsible for all the manual work? Because if I am, I'll turn around, shut my mouth, and go do it. But if I'm not the only one that's responsible, you know, I would like some help."

And I gave Bob the option that day of being straight with me, and he told me, "Absolutely not. 100% you're not responsible for all the manual stuff. You and Chuck when manual work comes back there, you guys gotta get it done." Okay. Perfect. That's all I needed to hear. And then I literally sit there for weeks on week doing mandrels 30, 40, sometimes 50, 60 mandrels a week. Chuck just sits back there on his phone.

So, I go back and I talk to Bob again, and I say, "Hey, Bob. I'm having a real problem here." And Bob's like, "Oh, what's wrong?"

I explained to him that I'm getting stuck with every manual job that comes back. Literally every job that comes back, Chuck is putting on my desk. Every mandrel comes back; he's putting on my desk. Or he's sending stuff out that isn't ready to go, and when it's brought back, it's put on my desk. And Bob tells me these are his exact words when I tell him this is too much for me, I just need some help, I need you to talk to Chuck and tell him, "Hey, gotta pitch in a little bit, man" his exact words were, "Mind your own business." So that was literally the moment I gave up at work. That was the time when I changed my whole mindset. That was the time when I decided I'm not killing myself back here anymore. I'm not running two to three machines anymore. I told my other supervisor, Dan. I said, "Dan, sometimes you just realize" I told him what happened, and I told him, "I'm just gonna come in, do what I need to do to get through the day, and then go home." And I was told by him, "Sometimes you gotta do what you gotta do, bud."

So, I did. I cut it down to one machine running. Just what I needed to do. So now this dead-end job was literally draining the life out of me. And through my various talks with Claude and everything about the job and about what unfairness goes on, about how they pile work on me time and time again and Chuck just sits there Chuck comes back from vacation with wood, and he's back there making pipes on the

machines while I'm struggling, pulling my hair out to get work done. So, I finally sat down with Claude, and I made an exit plan. And by this time, February, hopefully, I'm not there anymore. By this time in February, hopefully, I'm just working for my own business. Hopefully, I can make that take off. Or even if I'm somewhere else, maybe doing something that I enjoy something that I like. Even if it's less money, I could take a pay cut, and if I could get a job that I like, that would be fine. Because I have finally come to the point where this dead-end job isn't going to suck the life out of me and everything else. It is time to move on from this dead-end job.

Looking back now, I realize it wasn't about me. I was taking it personally, but Chuck wasn't trying to screw me over. He was protecting himself from the job the same way I was. We were both just trying to survive the same broken system. It was selfish of me to feel like he was attacking me. Now thinking back about it, I was way off base. So, the day before Christmas break, I want to Chuck and apologized, I felt so much better.

And, you know, in the middle of February, when I take my two weeks' vacation in the middle of February, they're gonna realize, "Oh, shit. He wasn't bullshitting." I have made many decisions in life I have regretted. This will not be one of them.

Section 3: What Would Actually Make Me Switch

Honestly, just me as a person giving them a chance to show me what value they provide. Even though I'm "afraid to change," I'd still be

willing to listen if someone approached it right. I'm not completely closed off I just need to feel safe about exploring the alternative. Here's what I would need: somebody to say, "Okay, bud. Here's the deal. We're not gonna give you the hard sell. Let us just explain what we offer, show you the prices. If it's not comparable or better, you go on your way. You do not lose anything. We don't lose anything."

That completely removes the fear of change. You're not asking for commitment, just permission to show value. No pressure, no tricks, no hard sales. Just put my mind at ease. I'm not gonna be standing there for half an hour saying:

- "No."
  "Yeah, I don't want to sign up."
- "Yeah, no, I don't want to sign up."
- "No, no, I really don't want to sign up. No, I'm not looking to sign up."

I don't wanna stand there for an hour doing that.

Section 4: Don't Turn It into a Timeshare Showing

Don't turn this cable company interaction into a freaking timeshare showing. That's exactly the nightmare scenario people are avoiding when they claim satisfaction with their current provider. Timeshare presentations are the ultimate example of sales harassment where you literally can't leave until they've beaten you down for hours. People aren't defending their cable company's honor they're trying to avoid

being trapped in a sales torture chamber. I mean, as soon as I see the cable people in the store they're always in Walmart when I go in there literally, as soon as I see them, I start veering off to the other side of the store so they can't catch me. I'm actively avoiding them like they're carrying the plague. Not because I love my cable company, but because I don't want to deal with the inevitable pressure and harassment.

Section 5: The Bottom Line on Trust

If you can promise me that you're not gonna make me if you can literally tell me, Hey. This is what I'm offering, this is the price, and I see value, then I'll probably go for it. I just need to know that if I say no, you don't pound me down with the hard sell. That's it. That's the whole psychology behind the "happy with my current provider" objection. It's not about loyalty it's about avoiding sales pressure.

Section 6: How This Applies to Algorithm Collective

Now, when I think about it from Algorithm Collective's point of view: "You're happy with your current provider." Well, there are not many people out there doing this. You have somebody doing artificial intelligence optimization for you? That's surprising. "Oh, no. You have somebody that does SEO."

Well, see, that's great because SEO is different. SEO is a totally different thing than we offer. We offer AIO. You're talking about

search engine optimization. You know, that old dinosaur walking around. And like I said before, I'm sure your guy is cool.

Maybe we can all go out and have dinner sometime. But here's the thing: you don't have to get rid of your guy to take advantage of the great services I offer. I charge you $100 a month. You can continue paying them $3,000, $4,000, $5,000 whatever crazy amount they're charging you to do a service that's on its way out. And I do my thing. I get your name popping up in the AI chatbots, and you start making money.

Section 7: The Price Advantage

And here's the thing. I'm gonna be perfectly honest with you, man. If it's the price if you're worried because I'm only charging $99 we do have an audit that's $299 a month. So at our premium level, we're still ten times cheaper than what SEO companies charge. Ten times cheaper with our premium service, and we're targeting technology that's actually growing instead of declining. We don't make our price based on what we think we could pull out of a company. We make our price based on what we think would be a great value to the company, and still leave them with something in the bank. Because these SEO companies literally charge like $2,500, $3,000 a month. And people pay it. But we're literally, at our high end, ten times cheaper.

Section 8: Position as Addition, Not Replacement

The beauty of this approach is you're not making them choose between providers. You're positioning yourself as complementary: Keep your current provider (removes fear of change) Add our service (low-risk addition, not replacement) SEO = expensive dinosaur service (3–5K monthly for outdated tech) AIO = future-focused, affordable ($100 for cutting-edge results) this completely neutralizes "I'm happy with my current provider" because you're not asking them to replace anyone. You're offering to add value while their current provider does… whatever it is they do.

Closing

"I'm happy with my current provider" is almost never about satisfaction. It's about fear of change, fear of sales pressure, fear of making things worse. Your job is to remove that fear:
Promise no high-pressure tactics Show clear value without demanding commitment Position as addition rather than replacement Make it safe for them to say no when you eliminate the fear of sales harassment and the risk of change, the loyalty objection disappears. Because it was never really about loyalty in the first place.

If you own a business, if you have a website, if you make money then AI, then AIO affects you. Period. The question isn't whether they need what you're offering. The question is whether you can make them feel safe enough to explore it without being trapped in a timeshare presentation. Do that, and "I'm happy with my current provider" becomes "Tell me more about what you do."

CHAPTER 7

I Don't Have Time

Opening

"I don't have time." That's just a broad term people use for every objection in the world. Basically. Just like we showed with "it's too expensive" being about everything but price, "I don't have time" is about everything but time. What "I don't have time" really means:

- "I don't see the value yet."
- "I'm not convinced this will work."
- "I don't trust you."
- "I have other priorities."
- "I'm overwhelmed and can't handle one more thing."
- "I don't want to deal with this right now."
- "This feels too complicated."

But "I don't have time" is the easy, socially acceptable way to say all of that without having to explain their real concerns or risk offending anyone.

Section 1: What They Really Mean

When someone says, "I don't have time," they're not sure it's gonna work. I mean, think about this from the Algorithm Collective standpoint. What do they need to do? They need to give me their business name, location, and website. Literally, three minutes. And make the payment. So, you know, let's chalk it up all the way to five whole minutes. They have five minutes. They have five minutes to get the answer on how they can start bringing in tens of thousands of dollars a month. I promise you. But you need to make them see that value. When they say "I don't have time," they're falling back on that old crutch and saying, "Okay.

Resolve this in my head for me. Maybe I don't see the value. Make me see the value. Maybe I don't trust you because I don't know you. Make me trust you." And that's what your job is. You need to dig in there and figure out what they're really telling you.

Personal "Time" Story

Let me give you a perfect example of how "I don't have time" works in real life. You walk into the store, and you see the cable company rep in front of you. They're rushing over with their foot forward, getting ready to sign you up. Your heart starts to pound, and they approach you saying, "Hey, sir. How's your day going? I'm from AT&T cable." You look at them and say, "I don't have time right now." But here's the thing you DO have the time. You're out

shopping. You knew you had this time. What you were really saying was, "I just don't want to deal with this right this second." Not that you didn't have time. You just didn't want to sit down and must make a decision. You were getting ripped off by your current cable company, and you were afraid of getting ripped off by a second one. So, you go back to the devil you know.

Maybe if you had taken the time to listen, he would have been able to tell you: "Well, sir, we don't have a contract, so you're not locked in for 3 to 5 years. And our price doesn't go up every single billing period. You don't start at $89 a month and in a year you're at $140." Had he had the time to tell you all that, you probably would've been like, "Oh my god, sign me up, please!" But your "I don't have time" cut him off prematurely. He didn't get to give you the information. You didn't get to switch to a better cable company. And you just kept paying, absorbing cable fees for crappy cable for the next year or two. That's what "I don't have time" really costs people not time, but opportunities.

Section 2: Breaking Down the Time Excuse

There's no harm in asking: "Well, I know you're saying you don't have time. But what's your real objection? Because time can't be the problem. You don't have to run the audit. All you gotta do is give me the info and pay. It takes five minutes." So, let's leave time out of this

and tell me what your real objection is. You're not gonna hurt my feelings. Don't you have faith in the company? Or are you afraid this isn't gonna work? Let's talk about it. That's the breakthrough moment when you solve the real puzzle when you finally figure out what "I don't have time" meant.

Section 3: The Real Problem Revealed

So, if they say, "I don't have time," then you say, "Well, here's what this process can do for you." And they say, "Yeah. I'm sorry. I still don't have time." First, realize they haven't ended the conversation. They're still giving you another chance. They're saying, "Come on. Solve this, buddy. You can do it." Maybe you finally say, "Oh, you know what? That's great. You don't have the time, but you're not the one that must do the audit. I'll do it. You don't need the time. You can spend the time doing what you need to do run your business. And I will handle the audit. You don't have to worry about it." Maybe that's what it is. They wanna know, "I really can't be involved with this. I'm so busy." And you're giving them permission to spend their time running their business while you handle the audit.

Section 4: Call Dialogue Example #1—Sarah the Attorney

Scenario: You're on a call with Sarah, a family law attorney in Pittsburgh. She responded to your outreach email but seems hesitant. You've explained the $299 AI visibility audit and she's pushing back.

- **Sarah**: "Look Ben, I appreciate what you're doing, but honestly, I just don't have time for this right now. We're swamped with cases and I can barely keep up with what we're already doing."
- **You**: "I totally understand what you're saying. I mean, first, you're an attorney. I get you're busy. Your time is literally worth money. But here's the good news, there's nothing you must do. You give me your website, you give me the payment, and your job is done. You get to go back to doing the lawyer thing and I will take care of the rest for you. There's literally nothing that we can't handle in five minutes over the phone right now. And then you're done. Here's the great thing I get that you're busy. I'm sure that's a great problem to have."
- **Sarah**: "Okay, but Ben, I've been burned before by marketing companies promising quick fixes. How do I know this isn't just another thing that sounds good but doesn't actually work? I mean, $299 isn't nothing for a small practice."
- **You**: "I understand what you're saying. We're not like the SEO companies charging $3,000–$4,000 month after month. It is $299, and that's not a small amount for anybody, regardless of what you make. That's literally hours' worth of your hard work. But I have lists of clients. I have people that you can talk to if you want to, to show you what we did for

them. So, you can see that we offer a valid service. And worst-case scenario, if I was some fly-by-night guy trying to scam a lawyer, you could sue me."

- **Sarah**: (laughing) "Ha! That's true, I suppose. Look, I can see you're being straight with me, which I appreciate. But help me understand if I do this audit and it shows problems, what then? Am I going to need to spend thousands more to fix anything, or hire another company to implement your recommendations?"
- **You**: "Yeah, perfect question. Very valid question. Here's the thing, there usually is no website that's so far gone it takes thousands of dollars to fix. Unless you were like a corporate place, like Walmart with thousands of stores, that might take thousands of dollars to fix. But you are a small law firm, your website shouldn't take that much to fix. If you have anyone you know or clients maybe that do web work, I'm giving you the roadmap so they can fix it. Now, we do implement the changes for people for a very small payment. It's usually around $300–$500 we can implement the changes. That's only if you want to do that. That's not something that's required. So, you can go with us, you can do it on your own, maybe you have a client you could trade work with. You take their case, and they do the website work. I mean, the website work isn't gonna be anywhere near what the value of your case is, but there are a lot of ways to handle the implementation when we get to the implementation."

- **Sarah**: "Okay, that actually sounds reasonable. So, I pay $299, get the full audit showing exactly what's wrong and how to fix it. Then I can decide whether to implement myself, have you do it, or find someone else. No pressure, no hidden costs. Is that right?"
- **You**: "You have nailed it exactly. That's 100% right. So basically, now I'll send you an invoice to go ahead and take care of, and I will get the link to your website via email, two or three more pieces of information. And in a few days, we'll be talking about the roadmap for fixing your AI visibility problems. And you'll feel so much better you did this, because now you're gonna be a step ahead of all these other law firms who don't even know this is a thing right now."
- **Sarah**: "Sounds good, Ben. Send me that invoice and I'll get it taken care of today. I'm actually excited to see what you find."

Section 5: When It's Actually a Valid Concern

Here's the thing. If there's really a reason you don't wanna do this like, say maybe you have a business but no website well, that still really doesn't matter… except for AIO, it does. For AIO, if you don't have a website, that's a perfectly valid reason. Say, "Hey. Don't say 'I don't have time.' Say, 'Hey. I don't have a website. I just have a business, no website.'" I'm gonna say, "Well, this probably won't work for you. I'm sorry." But just being open like that stops that conversation right

there, and we don't have to go down this long winding road for no reason.

Section 6: Call Dialogue

Example #2: Mike the Restaurant Owner

Scenario: You're talking to Mike, who owns a pizza restaurant in Pittsburgh. He responded to your AI visibility outreach but sounds overwhelmed.

- **Mike**: "Look Ben, I appreciate you reaching out about this AI stuff, but I honestly don't have time for any of this right now. I'm here 12 hours a day just trying to keep the doors open. Between staffing issues, supply costs going crazy, and everything else I can't take on one more thing. I don't even know what this AI visibility thing is, and I definitely don't have time to learn about it."
- **You**: "You know what, Mike. This works out great. We handle everything for you. There's literally not one single thing you must do except pay the invoice and give me your website. That's literally all you must do. And you can 100% worry about the stuff that you're worried about. There's nothing you must do besides that. I'm making a deal after we do this and I will give you the audit and you realize how easy it was for you, I'll let you buy me a pizza. How's that sound?"
- **Mike**: (laughing) "Ha! Alright, you got a deal on the pizza. So, you're telling me I literally just pay you and give you my

website, and that's it? You handle all the technical stuff, figure out why people aren't finding me when they ask their phone for pizza recommendations?"

- **You**: "Well, Mike, I know it's hard to believe anything could be that easy, especially after you've dealt with some of these companies out there that, all they're worried about is what they can get out of you. There's a lot of companies like that, but thankfully, Algorithm Collective wasn't started to be one of those companies. To answer your question, yeah, you hit the nail on the head 100%. You pay the invoice, you give me your website, you give me your email. We're done. I'll go ahead and run this for you, and you can start making that pizza. We can meet again in about two days to go over this, and I'll give you the roadmap. And we can talk about where you want to go from there. That simple. And after I give you the roadmap, if you never want to see me again, see, that's the genius part of this. I will give you the information on what's wrong, so at that point, I'm not the only person that could fix it. You could have any family or friend you know implement it for you."
- **Mike**: "You know what, Ben. That makes me feel a lot better. Most marketing guys want to lock you into long contracts. Alright, send me that invoice. Let's do this thing."

Section 7: Trust as the Real Objection

And, I mean, if your real objection is, "Hey. I never heard of your company, and I'm scared to work with you because I don't know you" well, then let me show you my testimonials. Let me show you our LLC certificate. Let me show you the website. Let me have you get to know us. This might be the best thing you've done in months. Spend this little bit of money. Spend this little bit of money and get this huge return.

Section 8: Don't Take It Personally

And when somebody says, "I don't trust you," don't take that personally. Why should they trust you? But what you do is take that graciously. Because they have just given you the key. They've just given you the key to put in their head and turn the gears and make them trust you. So don't take offense. Don't be upset. Don't get frustrated. Don't be defensive. I mean, you should really be thanking them for being honest. And I would rather hear "I don't trust you" a hundred times than deal with fake objections like "I don't have time" or "I need to think about it." Because "I don't trust you" gives you everything you need:

- Clear direction on what to address
- Permission to prove your credibility
- A real problem you can solve
- Honest communication instead of games

Section 9: The Absurdity of the Time Objection

I mean, who needs time to think about making more money? You know? That doesn't make sense. Think of it like this: If I came up to you and said, "Hey. Do you wanna make more money?" There's not a chance in hell you would ever say, "You know what? Let me think about that." Nope. You wanna make money? Sign me up. Nobody needs time to think about whether they want more revenue for their business. The answer is always yes immediately and enthusiastically.

So, when someone says "I don't have time" to your pitch about helping their business grow, what they're really saying is:

- "I don't believe you can actually make me more money."
- "This sounds too good to be true."
- "I'm skeptical this will work."
- "Prove to me this isn't a waste of money."

But "I don't have time" feels safer to say than "I think you're probably lying about the results."

Section 10: The Priority Test

When people say they don't have time, usually there's a whole bunch of other reasons they don't believe in the product, they don't believe in the promises. There are a ton of reasons why they say they don't have time, but it's almost never actually about time. So how you get around that is you just press the issue: "You really don't have five minutes? If you give me five minutes of your time, I can show you how your company can make more money every single month." I

don't know anybody that doesn't have five minutes so I can show them how to make more money for their company.

Or you tell them, "Hey, if I proved to you that this could work, would you give me five minutes of your time?" And they say, "Well, if you could prove it could work…Hurry up. Grab your cell phone. Get an old client on the phone. "Hey John, I'm here with a new client of mine, bud. Can you explain to him what we did for you?" And John tells them, "Oh man, my sales went up 30% a month ever since you started doing the AI visibility audit with us. We've been happier, we've been making money. Everything's been going great."
You just proved the value to them. And I bet you that person is now, instead of saying "I don't have five minutes," they're saying, "Oh my god, please sign me up!" Because what else could they say at that point?

Closing

"I don't have time" is the universal cover-up objection. It's socially acceptable, hard to argue with, and covers up whatever their real concern is. Your job is to call it out respectfully but directly: "What can sending you information do for you that I can't explain to you right now?" When they can't give you a good answer, you know it's a stall. When they give you a real answer, "I need to show this to my business partner" or "I've never heard of your company" then you have something real to work with.

Don't waste time solving fake time management problems when the real issue is trust, value uncertainty, or fear of results. Five minutes to potentially transform their business isn't a time problem. It's a belief problem. And belief problems get solved through proof, credibility, and honest conversation not by giving people more time to sit alone with their doubts. So, stop accepting "I don't have time" as an answer. Dig deeper. Find the real objection. Then solve that actual problem. Because nobody, and I mean nobody is too busy to spend five minutes making tens of thousands of dollars more per month. They're just not convinced yet that those five minutes will do it. That's what you need to fix. Not their calendar. Let me tell you about a guy named John. Johnny owned a pizzeria. We tried to help him by setting up his AI visibility, getting everything optimized, get him showing up in recommendations. When we talked to him, he was adamant he didn't have time. He wanted to wait. I told him, "Look, you don't need time, brother. We take care of it for you. There's no reason for you to have time. We have the time. You run your business. That's how this goes. Simple." But he kept arguing with us: "We don't have time. We don't have time."

Unfortunately, he said "we don't have time" one too many times, and I finally took him at his word. "Well, you must just be too busy. That's fine." So we moved on. About a month and a half later, he called me and said, "Hey, I'm sorry, man. You know what? You might've been right with all that stuff you were talking about. We really need to get this audit done. You were right." And I'm like, "John… sorry, bud.

I’ve got some bad news. What's the matter? "I don't have time. I'm not trying to be an asshole, but I literally don't have time. I have audits lined up for the next two weeks.

Once we're done with all the current work, maybe we can see if we can squeeze you in, but right now, I genuinely don’t have the time."

By sitting back and waiting, he put himself in a position where now he either must get it done with an inferior company that's gonna take advantage of him and lock him into a $2,000–$3,000 a month contract… or just forget it entirely and lose out. Either choice costs his business. Wait three weeks? Lose out on all that income in the meantime? That is what "not having time" costs him.

CHAPTER 8

I'm Not The Decision Maker

Opening

"I'm not the decision maker." That's another stall tactic. I mean, when I was in telemarketing, I used to get that all the time. "Oh, I gotta talk to my better half before I can donate $20." Wait. You can't spend $20 without talking to your husband or your wife? That doesn't make sense. There's no way that's true. That would mean you can't go to the grocery store without taking your husband or wife. You can't get anything done on your car without taking your husband or wife. You can't even grab lunch without taking your husband or wife? Doesn't make sense.

Section 1: What Authority Objections Really Mean

So, then it becomes: Okay, let's find out what they're really saying. And it's probably going to come back to:

- "I don't know if the service is gonna work."
- "I don't know if the service is gonna be worth it."
- "I don't know who you are."

I'm thinking those are probably going to be their main objections.

- "I'm not the decision maker" is just another way of saying:

- "I'm scared to make this decision alone."
- "I want someone else to blame if it goes wrong."
- "I need more confidence before I can commit."
- "I don't feel comfortable with you yet."

It's just using authority as a shield instead of saying what they're afraid of.

Section 2: The $20 Reality Check

When someone says they need to talk to their spouse about $20, or their business partner about $99, let's be real about what that means. You make dozens of spending decisions daily without consulting anyone coffee, lunch, gas, groceries, impulse purchases at the store. But suddenly you need approval for a business investment that could generate thousands in additional revenue? That's not a real authority constraint. That's a stall tactic dressed up as responsibility.

Section 3: Real Authority vs. Fake Authority

Now, I'm not saying all authority constraints are fake. There's a difference between:

Real authority constraints:

- Corporate procurement processes
- Board approval requirements
- Major capital expenditures ($2,000–$5,000+)
- Legitimate partnership agreements

Fake authority constraints:

- "I need to talk to my spouse" about pocket-change amounts
- Business owners who "can't make decisions" for their own businesses
- Solo entrepreneurs who suddenly need committee approval
- Anyone claiming they need permission for amounts they spend freely elsewhere.

Section 4: The Business Owner Reality

Because we're not asking right now we're not asking for a monthly payment or some huge $2,000, $3,000, $4,000, $5,000 transmission fix. Because honestly, if you get into stuff like that, you might have to talk to somebody before you do it. I understand that. But we're talking about $100 here. And if I'm talking to the business owner if you're not the decision maker for your business, then who is? That's the question that exposes the whole objection. A business owner who can't authorize $100 for potential revenue growth isn't really running a business.

Section 5: Don't Be Afraid to Push Back

And that's also the thing: Don't be afraid to push back a little bit. When they say, "Oh, I need to talk to someone else. I can't make that decision," don't be afraid to say, "Wait. You are the business owner, correct?" Don't be afraid to say, "You own a business, but you can't make a $100 decision?" Because then that kind of lets them see how

silly that sounds. And they might come out and tell you the real reason. "Sorry. I don't know you." Well, now we can fix that. "I don't know if the service is good enough." Now we can fix that. You see what I'm saying?

Section 6: Call Dialogue

#1—Mike's HVAC Solutions

Here's how this plays out in real life. I called Mike, who owns an HVAC company in Pittsburgh:

- **Mike**: "Look, I appreciate you calling about this AI visibility stuff, but honestly, I'm not the decision maker here. I'd have to run this by my business partner before we could move forward with anything like this. Can you just send me some information I can show him?"
- **Me**: "Hey, Mike. How's it going, bro? Hey, I'm not trying to be pushy here, but I just wanna straighten something up and make sure I'm talking to the right person. My records show that you're the owner of the HVAC company. Is that correct?"
- **Mike:** "Yeah, that's right, I am the owner. I mean, me and my buddy Tony started this thing together about eight years ago. We're partners, you know? I handle most of the day-to-day stuff, but for big spending decisions, we usually talk it through first. That's just how we've always done it."

- **Me**: "Hey, there's nothing better than having a good partner by your side when you're trying to run a business. It can make it such a better experience. I understand for the big expense's you guys wanna talk it out, but this is literally a $99 audit. It's not something I think qualifies as a huge expense. Being a business owner, I'm sure you can make the decision about $99."
- **Mike**: "Well, I mean... yeah, $99 isn't huge, but... look, Tony and I, we just have this agreement, you know? We talk about stuff before we spend money on new services. It's not about the amount, it's about... I don't know, just keeping each other in the loop. Plus, I'm not even sure what this AI thing is all about. Maybe if you could just email me some details, I could show Tony and we could discuss it?"
- **Me**: "Well, you know, that's perfect. Here's the thing. Luckily, you're not getting into a monthly service. This is just $99 one time. And here's the important part: if something goes horribly wrong after we go through this, you do your audit, and Tony absolutely flips out over it, all you gotta do is give me a call and cancel. If it doesn't work out, I don't mind giving you the $99 back. I just know this is such a great service that you're literally losing out by not doing it."
- **Mike**: "Wait a minute... hold on. You're saying if Tony doesn't like it, you will give me my money back? Even after you do the audit work? I mean... I guess that does take some of the pressure off. But still, man, I just... I don't really know much

about this AI stuff. How do I know this isn't just some scam? No offense, but I get calls all the time from people trying to sell me website stuff and marketing crap that never works."

- **Me**: "No, I get it. There's a lot of companies out there that promise you the world and leave you empty handed. I'd almost think less of you if you didn't care where your money's going. Basically, I have a list of clients here. I can show you what they were making per month, and what they started making within a few months after AI started recommending their business to people. The difference is the proof. It's worked for other companies, and there's no reason it wouldn't work for you."
- **Mike**: "You know what... that does make me feel better about this. And if you're willing to give me my money back if Tony has a problem with it... Alright, you know what? You're right. I make $100 decisions all the time without calling Tony. Hell, I spent $120 on lunch for the crew yesterday and didn't think twice about it. And if this AI thing really is helping other HVAC companies get more customers... Okay, let's do it. What do I need to do to get this audit started?"

See what happened there? Mike went from "I need to talk to my partner" to "let's do it" once I addressed the real concerns: trust, proof, and risk.

Section 7: Call Dialogue

#2—Pittsburgh Property Management

Here's a trickier one. Sarah runs a property management company and came at me with the sophisticated corporate angle:

- **Sarah**: "I appreciate the call about this AI audit service, but we have established procurement procedures here at Pittsburgh Property Management. Any vendor expenditure over $50 have to go through our quarterly vendor review process with our board of advisors. I'd be happy to add your company to our vendor consideration list for next quarter's meeting in March. Can you send me your company information and a formal proposal?"
- **Me**: "I'll be honest with you. I would have no problem sending you an email with information. But what I've found is, 9 times out of 10, nobody responds. I don't hear anything again. Nobody writes back. So unfortunately, I find this is usually just a delay tactic and somebody trying to get off the phone. "Now literally $99 isn't a huge amount. And here's the important part: because we just started doing the audits in your area, I expect our slots to fill up fast. If you wait six months, everyone else is gonna be ahead of you in the game. In the business game, you're gonna be dead last. So if that's a chance, you're willing to take, I mean, that's one way we can handle it."
- **Sarah**: "You know what... you're right. $99 isn't exactly a board-level decision. And I have been putting off dealing with

> our online presence issues. When you put it that way everyone else getting ahead while I'm waiting for a quarterly meeting… Look, I run 47 units and I need every competitive advantage I can get. If waiting six months means I'm behind every other property management company in Pittsburgh when people are searching for us... Fine. You made your point. What do I need to do to get this $99 audit done? But I want to see some real results, not just another report that sits on my desk."

The corporate procedures were just a shield. The real concern was competitive positioning once she saw she'd be falling behind, the "board approval" excuse disappeared.

Section 8: The Permission Pattern

Just like with other objections, what people often need isn't really authority they need permission. Permission to feel confident about the decision. Permission to trust you. Permission to believe it will work. When someone hides behind "I'm not the decision maker," they're really asking: "Can you make me feel safe enough to make this decision without needing backup?" Your job is to give them that confidence, not to accept the authority excuse at face value.

Section 9: Scale Matters

Here's the reality check on authority objections: scale matters.

If you're asking for $100 and talking to a business owner, there's no real authority issue. They make $100 decisions every day without

consulting anyone. If you're asking for $5,000 from a mid-level manager at a corporation, yeah, they probably do need approval. That's legitimate. The key is to match the amount to the person's actual decision-making authority. And when those don't match up when a business owner claims they can't authorize pocket change you know you're dealing with a fake authority objection covering a real fear.

Section 10: The Trust Breakthrough

And I would rather hear "I don't trust you" a hundred times than keep chasing fake authority excuses. Because "I don't trust you" gives you something real to work with. You can show testimonials. You can share your LLC certificate. You can demonstrate your track record. You can have an honest conversation about credibility. But "I need to talk to my business partner" when they're the sole owner? That just leaves you waiting for a conversation that's never going to happen with a person who doesn't exist.

Section 11: Analysis Paralysis and the Real Cost of Delay

If you're so frozen by the fear of making a $99 decision that you need committee approval, I'm not sure how you've been running a business this long. Because here's what happens while you're agonizing over pocket change: all the businesses around you that are making

decisions are growing and moving forward. Unfortunately, you're sitting stagnant or losing out while they're gaining ground. That's the real cost of the authority excuse not the $99 you're afraid to spend, but the opportunities you're missing while you pretend to "think it over."

Now look, there's nothing wrong with saying, "Hey, I need a night to consider this." That's honest. That's legitimate. But 90% of the time when somebody tells me, "I wanna talk to my partner," or "I need to run this by someone," it comes down to they just don't want to answer the question right now. They're trying to put it off.

Section 12: The Real Numbers on "I'll Get Back to You"

And here's the brutal truth: 99% of the time when someone uses the authority excuse, I never get an answer. I never hear from them again. They don't call back. They don't email. They just disappeared. So, the only thing I can say is this if the reason you're not moving forward is because you don't want the service, just be honest with the salesman and tell them the real reason.

Section 13: For My Fellow Salespeople

And for all my salespeople out there: press them on the "I gotta ask somebody" excuse. Press them hard. Because all that pressing does is

lead to the real reason they won't sign up. And then you have something real you can work with and maybe change their mind.

Closing: The Choice Is Simple

"I'm not the decision maker" is almost always about fear, not authority. Your job is to call it out respectfully but directly: "You're the business owner, right? And we're talking about $99. So, what's your real concern?" When they can't justify the authority excuse, one of three things happens:

- They tell you their real objection (now you can solve it)
- They admit they're not serious (now you can move on)
- They realize how silly it sounds and just make the decision

All three outcomes are better than accepting fake authority objection and wasting weeks chasing phantom decision makers. Because here's the truth: You get them a customer that makes them $5,000 because they're showing up in the AI searches suddenly, they're still gonna get $5,000 off that customer whether they made the decision alone or with their spouse, their partner, their board, or their imaginary committee.

The value you deliver doesn't change based on who approved the purchase. So, stop accepting authority objections when you're talking to the actual decision maker about amounts they have clear authority to spend. Challenge it. Expose it. Then address the real concern hiding

underneath. That's how you turn "I'm not the decision maker" from a dead end into a closed deal.

CHAPTER 9

It Won't Work For My Industry

Opening

"It won't work for my industry." Honestly, when they say that, I think the problem is and what they're really saying is "I don't know much about AI. I'm embarrassed to say I don't know what AIO is. I don't know what AIO does. I don't know a lot about AI, so I don't think it applies to me. If I don't know about it, then obviously it doesn't apply to me." And I believe that's what the objection really is. They're using "it won't work for my industry" to cover up their embarrassment about not understanding the technology. Rather than admit ignorance, they claim their business is somehow exempt from needing AI visibility.

Section 1: What This Objection Really Means

When people don't understand something, they often convince themselves it's not relevant to them rather than admit they need to learn about it. "It won't work for my industry" really means:

- "I don't understand how AI recommendations work."
- "This technology feels over my head."
- "I'm embarrassed to ask basic questions."

- "If I don't get it, it must not apply to me."

It's classic psychology. When faced with something new and potentially confusing, people protect their ego by deciding it doesn't matter for them anyway.

Section 2: The Education Approach

And, basically, if they say, "it won't work for my industry," maybe the first thing you do is say: "You know what? Let me just sit down and explain it to you. Let me sit down and explain to you how the whole AI thing works, and how the whole AIO optimization works. Because if you have a business if you have a website then it 100% does pertain to your industry." That's the key. Instead of arguing about industry relevance, you educate them about the basics. Once they understand that AI recommendations happen across ALL industries, the objection dissolves completely. Your approach removes their embarrassment by positioning it as, "Let me explain," rather than, "You should already know this." That makes it safe for them to learn without feeling stupid.

Section 3: The Universal Truth

The universal truth you're teaching: If someone can ask AI about their industry, then AI visibility applies to their industry. And people ask AI about EVERYTHING:

- "Best lawyer in Denver"
- "Good plumber near me"
- "Reliable contractor in Phoenix"
- "Top dentist in Miami"
- "Italian restaurant recommendations"
- "Who should I hire for accounting?"
- "Best physical therapist in my area"

When you show them this simple reality, "it won't work for my industry" becomes obviously false. AI doesn't care what industry you're in it just recommends based on who has the best visibility and trust signals.

Section 4: The Plumber Example

If people don't ask AI about plumbers, why are there programs like Angi and all that other stuff? People ask online. I promise. When they're sitting at home and a pipe breaks, you think they're gonna go ask their neighbors at 2 a.m.? No. They're grabbing their phone and asking "emergency plumber near me" or "24-hour plumber in [city]." And increasingly, they're asking ChatGPT, Claude, or other AI tools for recommendations. Angi, HomeAdvisor, Thumbtack—these platforms exist because people DO search online for service providers. And now AI is just the next evolution of that same behavior. If people were only using word-of-mouth and repeat customers, these massive online platforms wouldn't exist and wouldn't be profitable.

Section 5: The Simple Formula

And here's the thing. If you own a business, if you have a website, if you make money then AI, then AIO affects you. That's the perfect simple formula that cuts through every industry objection. It doesn't matter if you're a plumber, lawyer, restaurant owner, contractor, consultant if you have customers and you want more of them, then AI visibility matters. Your three-part test eliminates all the "special snowflake" thinking:

- Do you own a business? Yes.
- Do you have a website? Yes.
- Do you make money? Yes.

Then AIO affects you. Period.

Section 6: Why You Have a Website

I mean, why do you have a website? It's so you can generate more buzz, get your word out to more people, and get more business. That's why you have a website. That's what the tool of a website does. Every business owner understands that basic truth websites exist to attract customers and generate business.

So, if that's the purpose of their website, then AIO becomes obvious:

- Website = tool to get found by potential customers
- AI = new way customers search for businesses

- AIO = making sure your website gets found when customers use AI

No industry exemptions are possible when you frame it that way. A plumber's website, a lawyer's website, a restaurant's website, they all exist for the same reason: to be found by potential customers. AIO just ensures they're found through the newest search method.

Section 7: The Impossible Challenge

I'll make a deal with you: if you can tell me an industry that AIO or AI wouldn't work for, I'll do your audit for free. That's the perfect challenge. Because there literally isn't an industry where AI wouldn't work if people can ask AI about it. And people ask AI about everything.

Your challenge is genius because:

- It's confident without being arrogant
- It proves your universal point
- It makes them think through their own logic
- It shows you're willing to put your money where your mouth is

The beauty is they can't name an industry, because if customers exist in that industry, then people will ask AI about businesses in that industry. Your challenge is literally impossible to win, which proves that AIO works everywhere.

Section 8: Call Dialogue

#1—Tony's Quality Roofing

Here's how this plays out in real life. I called Tony, who owns a roofing company:

- **Tony:** "Look, I appreciate the call, but this AI visibility stuff... I mean, that's for lawyers and tech companies and fancy businesses like that. I run a roofing company. People need a roof, they ask their neighbors or they drive around and see our trucks. This AI computer stuff ain't gonna work for my industry. Roofing is all about word-of-mouth and reputation, not some internet thing."
- **Me:** "Tony, don't sell yourself short, pal. This isn't just for lawyers and tech companies. This includes roofers, because when people have a leak in the roof, they used to go to Google and say, 'Hey Google, I need a roofer near me.' Now the quickest way for them to get a legitimate company is to pick up their phone, grab one of the chatbots, Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini and say, 'Hey, I have a leak in my roof. Who should I call? Who's near me?' And the chatbot gives them good companies. So, it most certainly includes you. "Now here's the thing. You already think what you're doing works. But this isn't to replace anything. This is in addition to. So, if we could add two or three clients a month to your roster, I'm sure that's something you would want."
- **Tony:** "Okay... I guess that makes sense. People do use their phones for everything now. My own kids are always talking to

those chat things instead of Googling stuff. And yeah, two or three more clients a month would help, especially during the slow seasons. But how do I know this AI thing is gonna recommend me instead of my competitors? I mean, there's a lot of roofers around here."

- **Me:** "Well, after we run your audit, it's gonna give us a list of everything you need to change so you can be recommended. As far as testing, that's the easiest part. You pick up your phone, and you say, 'Hey, can you recommend me a roofing company in this city, this state?' See if they start naming you."
- **Tony:** "Oh, so you actually test it? Like I can check if it's working? That's... that's smart, actually. I like that I can see if I'm getting recommended or not. And you're saying this audit will tell me exactly what I need to fix to show up when people ask for roofers in my area?"
- **Me:** "It'll definitely tell you what you need to fix. As with anything in life, there's no guarantee that you're gonna wake up tomorrow and be number one on the list. It might take a little bit of time. But what we do is we work on getting your business out there and getting those customers in to get you another two, three jobs a month. I'm sure there's nobody here that would turn down two or three jobs a month."
- **Tony:** "Hell no, I wouldn't turn down two or three more jobs a month. That's probably an extra fifteen to twenty grand if they're decent-sized jobs. And you're honest about it not happening overnight I appreciate that. Most people who call

me promise the moon. So, what exactly does this audit cost, and what am I looking at for getting this set up?"

- **Me:** "Okay, Tony. I want you to steel yourself here, okay? I'm gonna give you the straight facts. For all this we're gonna charge you $99 one time. That's all. All the future money you get from this audit comes at a cost of $99 one time. And you probably think it's a big thing to set up—I need your business name, your email, your URL for your website, and your phone number, Tony. That's all I need."
- **Tony:** "Wait a minute... $99? That's it? Shit, I spend more than that on lunch for my crew when we're working a big job. And you just need my business info? I was expecting you to want like $2,000 upfront or some monthly payment thing."
- **Me:** "Hey, Tony. If you wanna throw money at us, you can. But we're only asking for $99."
- **Tony:** "You know what, I like you, man. You're straight up about everything. Hell yeah, let's do this thing. Give me the details on how to get started."

See what happened there? Tony went from "this is for fancy businesses" to "hell yeah, let's do this" because I educated him instead of arguing with him.

Section 9: Call Dialogue

#2—Pittsburgh Compliance Consulting

Here's a trickier one. Rachel runs a B2B consulting firm and came at me with the sophisticated angle:

- **Rachel:** "I appreciate you reaching out, but honestly, this AI visibility thing just isn't going to work for my industry. I do very specialized compliance consulting for mid-market manufacturing companies. Its extremely niche people don't just search online for this kind of expertise. All my business comes from referrals and industry connections. I doubt AI even understands what I do, let alone recommend me to the right clients."
- **Me:** "You know what? Let's check, Rachel. Let's see what AI understands and what they don't. What I'm gonna do is open ChatGPT and ask it for businesses in your area that do the same business as you. And it's gonna name four or five businesses in your area that do the exact same thing. That's exactly what it does. So that shows that AI understands your niche. It's already recommending people doing what you do, but it's not recommending you. That's why you need the audit."
- **Rachel:** "Okay... wait, you're saying if I ask ChatGPT right now for compliance consultants in my area, it's actually going to give me names? And... oh God, you're telling me it's already recommending my competitors but not me? That's... that's terrifying. I had no idea AI was already making recommendations in my space."

- **Me:** "Hey, it's okay. There's a lot of people right now that are invisible. This is a new and emerging thing. So luckily, we have the chance to get in right on the cusp of it and be one of the first businesses to get out there. This is new. You still have time."
- **Rachel:** "Oh my God, you're right. If this is still new and emerging, then I need to get ahead of this before everyone else figures it out. How quickly can we get this audit done?"
- **Me:** "For the audit, we can probably have it done in 24 to 48 hours. We'll send you an invoice. You pay that you put in your business URL, business name, your email, and your phone number so I can contact you. In 24 to 48 hours, I can be sitting you down and telling you exactly what steps to take to get your business recognized by AI."
- **Rachel:** "24 to 48 hours? That's incredibly fast. What's the investment for this audit?"
- **Me:** "We actually have two different audits. There's a starter audit for $99. But you also have a full professional audit. It's $299 and it includes an hour-long Loom video, a half-hour talk, the Loom video walks you through the entire audit, and a 15–20 page PDF showing you your competitors and step-by-step, week-by-week, in chronological order what you need to do to get your visibility up. So, it just depends on which one you want."
- **Rachel:** "You know what, if I'm going to do this, I want to do it right. The $299 option with the full walkthrough video

and the detailed PDF that sounds like exactly what I need. How do we get started with the full audit?"

See how Rachel went from "AI doesn't understand my niche" to choosing the premium $299 audit? Once I showed her that AI was already recommending her competitors, the objection disappeared and urgency kicked in.

Section 10: The Pizza Shop That Closed

I met a guy in Sewickley who owned a pizza shop. He was really of the mind that this wouldn't work for him. "This isn't for me. This won't work for me." I went through all the objections. I told him everything I should have told him. But he just kept giving me a hard time that it wasn't for him. So, here's the thing the smartest thing you can do when somebody does that is cut your losses, honestly. There's no reason to spend hours and hours trying to talk this person through a sale that's probably never gonna happen. That's something else we talked about earlier in the book: not every client is gonna be a sale. Not every single person you see is gonna be a sale. Not all leads are created equal. And that's just the bottom line.

Something you gotta keep in your head: when you finally realize it's a no, your job is to end it and get on to that next yes as fast as you can. Soon as I realized he was a no, I said, "Alright. Well, sorry we couldn't work something out." And I left. Got on to somebody that did want my service. And, unfortunately, three months later, he ended up closing his shop down.

And I always wonder to this day: What if he had listened? What if he had tried my service? Would it have made a difference? And you know what? I guarantee in his case it would have. I guarantee he still sits there sometimes thinking, "Maybe I should have listened to that kid from Algorithm Collective. Maybe it would have brought the customers in that I needed to stay open." And I guess we'll never find out.

Section 11: The "I Tried Digital Marketing Before" Objection

Sometimes "it won't work for my industry" comes with baggage. They got burned before.

- **Client:** "Look, I appreciate what you're saying about this AI stuff, but I've been down this road before. I spent $3,000 on Google Ads last year and got maybe two customers out of it. Tried Facebook marketing, SEO, all that digital crap. None of it worked for my business. I'm not throwing good money after bad on another internet marketing scheme that promises the world."
- **Me:** "Let me ask you something. Who did that for you? Was it a marketing company that placed all those ads for you?"
- **Client:** "Yeah, it was some marketing company. Local guys who said they specialized in businesses like mine. They promised me leads, conversions, the whole nine yards. Set up

all the campaigns, wrote the ads, managed everything. Charged me a monthly fee on top of the ad spend. Total waste of money barely got any real customers out of it."

- **Me:** "You know what? Yeah. Unfortunately, my friend, not all these marketing companies are created equal, if you know what I mean. Some of them are literally out here just to get as much money out of you as they can. But think about this. If I was trying to come out here and rip you off, I wouldn't be asking for $99. I'd be asking for two or three thousand dollars. Think about that first.
- "And I have a list of companies I can give you that shows we helped them gain customers and gain revenue last year. I'm willing to give you that list."
- **Client:** "You know... that's actually a good point. Those marketing guys did want $2,500 upfront plus monthly fees. And you're right, if this was a scam, you'd probably be asking for a lot more than $99. And you said you have actual client results I can, see?"
- **Me:** "Oh, I can definitely put you in touch with at least two or three of my old customers if you like that are gonna give you the real answer. Let's call them and talk to them. Let you hear the words come out of their mouth."
- **Client:** "Hold on... you're saying I can actually call these people myself and ask them directly what happened? Not just read some testimonials you wrote up, but actually talk to real business owners who paid for this AI audit. That's... that's

completely different from what those marketing guys offered. They just had generic testimonials with first names only."

- Me: "Yeah. I'm more than willing to do that. I don't understand why anybody wouldn't be willing to. If you're getting testimonials with first names only and you can't talk to them that makes me wonder did they even exist?"
- **Client:** "Exactly! Now that you mention it, those testimonials were probably completely made up. 'John from Denver increased his sales by 300%' no last name, no business name, no way to verify anything. Man, I feel like an idiot for falling for that."
- **Me:** "Don't ever feel like an idiot because a bad person tricked a good person. Don't ever feel bad about that. That's what bad people do. That's all bad people do."
- **Client:** "You know what... thanks for saying that. That actually means a lot. So... tell me more about this $99 audit."

Section 12: Be a Human Being

You don't have to always be on somebody's back with the sale. Bad people prey on good people who are just trying to improve their businesses. When someone tells you they got burned before, don't make them feel stupid about it show them empathy. You can take a little bit of time here and there to be a human being. That's what separates honest salespeople from predators. Sometimes the most powerful thing you can do is acknowledge their pain instead of

pushing harder for the close. When you show genuine empathy, you're not just making a sale, you’re building trust that turns skeptics into believers.

Closing

"It won't work for my industry" is almost never about industry, it's about understanding. When someone claims their business is exempt from AI visibility, they're really saying they don't understand how AI works yet. Your job isn't to argue about their industry, it's to educate them about technology.

Show them that:

- People ask AI about every industry
- Their website exists to get found by customers
- AI is just the newest way customers search

Every business with customers’ needs to be visible when those customers ask AI for help

Then challenge them: "Name one industry where customers don't ask AI for recommendations. I'll wait."

They can't. Because there isn't one. If you have a business, if you have a website, if you make money then AIO affects you. The only question is whether you want to be the business AI recommends, or the one that stays invisible while your competitors get found.

CHAPTER 10

Send Me Information

Opening

"Send me information." I honestly think that in most cases, they just don't wanna get into it and they're trying to push you away. Why am I gonna go pay money to print all these materials, send them to you—so you can get the materials and then throw them in the trash? Why? When in 10 minutes, I can explain the whole thing to you and why you need it. "Send me information" is a stall. And you can rebut it by saying: "You know what? Here's my number. When you're ready to talk, just give me a call. And don't be surprised if tomorrow we get 30–40 audits in, and you call me and say, 'Hey, I wanna do this.' Guess what end of that 30–40 audit line you're on?" They'll call back from their spot, and that's for sure.

Section 1: What "Send Me Information" Really Means

"Send me information" is almost always a polite way to end the conversation without saying "I'm not interested." They're giving you busy work that leads nowhere.

Here's the reality:

- You spend money printing materials
- You spend time mailing or emailing them
- They throw it away without reading it

Meanwhile, you could explain everything they need to know in 10 minutes, answer their questions, and help them understand the value.

Section 2: The Real Issue

Because see, there's nothing we can't handle right here. Whatever questions they have, whatever concerns are holding them back, whatever information they think they need you can address all of it in a 10-minute conversation right now. There's literally nothing that printing and mailing materials accomplishes that you can't do better in real time:

- Questions? You can answer immediately
- Concerns? You can address on the spot
- Pricing? You can explain clearly
- Process? You can walk them through it
- Results? You can show proof

"Send me information" is just a way to avoid that conversation because they're not ready to decide or they hope you'll go away.

Section 3: Qualifying the Request

The first thing I'd ask is: "What can sending you information do for you that I can't explain to you right now?"
If they give a legitimate reason, then sure, send something.

This forces them to either:

- Admit it's a stall (they won't have a real answer)
- Reveal their real concern
- Ask genuine questions you can answer immediately

Legitimate reasons:

- "My business partner needs to review it."
- "This needs board approval."
- "My accountant reviews all expenses."

Stall reasons:

- "I just like to review things."
- "I want to think it over."
- "I need it in writing" (but they can't say why).

Section 4: Low-Cost Alternatives

There are tons of ways to send information without wasting money:

- Direct them to your website

- Email a simple one-page summary
- Create a quick flyer at home
- Send only what they actually need

Don't go spending money on expensive marketing materials for someone who isn't even serious.

Section 5: Setting Boundaries

When someone chooses to stall instead of having a real conversation, they're choosing to lose their priority position.

Don't chase people who aren't ready. Your time is valuable. Invest it in people who want their problem solved not in people who want to collect brochures like Pokémon cards.

Section 6: Call Dialogue

#1 — The Polite Brush-Off

Here's how this plays out when "send me information" is a stall.

- **Sarah:** "This sounds interesting, but I really need to review everything carefully. Can you email me some information?"
- **Me:** "Sarah, let me ask you something. What could I send in an email that I can't explain in the next 5 minutes right here?" Sarah tries to justify it… I call out the brush-off respectfully…

Then I create urgency:

- **Me:** "If you wait to think about it and call me next week, I might have 30 businesses ahead of you. That could be a 20-day wait. Do you want to risk that?"
- **Sarah:** "No, absolutely not. Let's just do it."

Boom. Objection gone.

Section 7: Call Dialogue

#2 — The Legitimate Reques

Mark: "I literally need to present this at our vendor meeting next Wednesday. It's policy." This is REAL.

So, I say: "I'll send the information, and I'll hold your spot until Thursday. If I don't hear from you by then, we're done. No chasing."

He respects that. He buys in. Some people truly do have processes. Handle them differently.

Section 8: When Information Requests Are Valid

Real info needs:

- They must talk to a partner with a specific date
- They must present it to a board with a scheduled meeting
- They must show pricing to an accountant

Fake info needs:

- Vague "I wanna review this"
- No timeline
- No clear reason

- Solo business owners pretending they need approval

Know the difference. Treat them differently.

Section 9: The Email Black Hole Reality

Let me be brutally honest. 99 out of 100 "send me information" requests are total brush-offs. And when you send that email? It disappears into the email black hole. They never read it. Never respond. Never buy. They do not care how much time you wasted preparing it. If they wanted to buy, they'd be talking to you not asking for homework.

Section 10: When I Learned This Lesson the Hard Way

Here's what happens when someone asks you to "send information."

- You print the materials.
- You get excited.
- You send everything over.

And then you never hear from them again. That feeling? Everyone in sales experiences it at least once. But that experience teaches you an important lesson: Don't waste three hours chasing a tire kicker when you could close three real buyers in the same amount of time. If someone makes you work this hard for a $99 decision, they will never buy more.

They will never upgrade.

They will never become a high-value client.

At some point, the right move isn't to try harder.

It's to walk away.

Closing: The Bottom Line

Here's the takeaway: "Send me information" is a waste of your time 99% of the time. You didn't fail. You didn't mess up. It's not your fault.

Some people simply aren't ready and instead of being honest, they choose the easy excuse.

Your job:

- Qualify the request
- Call out the stall politely
- Protect your time
- Move on when they can't give a real reason
- Serious prospects want solutions.
- Tire kickers want brochures.
- Know the difference.
- Act accordingly.

Protect your energy for the people who are ready to say yes.

If they're not gonna get it, they're not gonna get it.

Period.

Complete Objections Practice

Alright, you've just learned how to handle the 7 most common objections in sales. Now it's time to practice. Don't just read this section and move on actually do the work. Grab a pen. Fill in your responses. This is where the rubber meets the road.

Remember: objections aren't roadblocks. They're puzzles. Your job is to figure out what the customer is really saying, then respond to that.

Note: Dollar amounts vary intentionally to reflect real-world situations.

Here's how this works:

I'm going to give you 7 objection scenarios one for each objection we covered in Chapters 4–10. For each one:

Identify what they're REALLY saying (not just the surface objection)

Write your LPR response (Listen, Process, Respond) Then check your answer against mine

Don't turn the page until you've written responses to all 7 scenarios.

SCENARIO 1: "It's Too Expensive"

You're selling a $299 AI visibility audit to a law firm owner. She says: "I appreciate the call, but $299 is just too expensive for us right now. We're already spending a lot on marketing."

What is she REALLY saying?

Your LPR Response:

SCENARIO 2: "I Need to Think About It"

You're selling to a restaurant owner. You've explained everything, answered his questions, and he says:
"This sounds interesting, but I really need some time to think it over. Can I call you back next week?"

What is he REALLY saying?

Your LPR Response:

SCENARIO 3: "I'm Happy With My Current Provider"

You're talking to a contractor about AI visibility. He says:
"Look, I appreciate the call, but we're already working with an SEO company and we're pretty happy with them. I don't think we need anything else right now."

What is he REALLY saying?

Your LPR Response:

SCENARIO 4: "I Don't Have Time"

You're on the phone with a medical practice office manager. She says: "I'm sorry, but I'm absolutely swamped right now. I just don't have time to deal with this. Maybe you can call back in a few months when things slow down."

What is she REALLY saying?

Your LPR Response:

SCENARIO 5: "I'm Not the Decision Maker"

You're talking to a business owner about a $99 audit. He says: "I'd love to help you out, but I need to run this by my business partner before I can make any decisions. Can you send me some information I can show him?"

What is he REALLY saying?

Your LPR Response:

SCENARIO 6: "It Won't Work For My Industry"

You're speaking with an accountant about AI visibility. She says:
"I don't think this AI stuff really applies to accounting. Our clients find us through referrals and word-of-mouth, not through internet searches."

What is she REALLY saying?

Your LPR Response:

SCENARIO 7: "Send Me Information"

You're on a call with a real estate agent. After your pitch, he says: "This sounds good, but I'd really like to review everything in writing before making a decision. Can you just email me all the details and I'll get back to you?"

What is he REALLY saying?

Your LPR Response:

Don't look at the answer key until you've filled out ALL 7 scenarios.

Answer Key

What They're Really Saying and How To Respond

SCENARIO 1: "It's Too Expensive"

What she's REALLY saying: She doesn't see the value yet. Or she's comparing your $299 to other marketing costs and doesn't understand the ROI difference. Or she's been burned before by expensive marketing that didn't work.

My LPR Response: "I totally understand $299 is money you're spending on your firm. But let's look at this differently. Your current marketing costs thousands per month, right? This is a one-time $299 to make sure you're visible when potential clients ask AI for lawyer recommendations. If this brings you even one new client, what's that client worth to your firm? Probably $5,000, $10,000, maybe more depending on the case. So, we're talking about spending $299 to potentially gain thousands. Does that math make sense?"

SCENARIO 2: "I Need to Think About It"

What he's REALLY saying: He's not convinced yet. Or he doesn't trust you. Or he's overwhelmed and using "think about it" to politely end the conversation. Or he genuinely needs to check his budget or talk to someone.

My LPR Response: "Absolutely, I understand you want to think it through. But let me ask you what specifically do you need to think about that I can't answer for you right now in the next 5–10 minutes? Is it the price? Is it whether this will work? Is it something else? Because if you have questions, I'd rather answer them now than have you sit on this for a week and forget about it. What's the real concern?"

SCENARIO 3: "I'm Happy with My Current Provider"

What he's REALLY saying: He's afraid of change. Or he doesn't want to deal with switching providers. Or he genuinely doesn't know that AI visibility is different from SEO.

My LPR Response: "That's great that you're happy with your SEO Company you should be working with people you trust. But here's the thing: what I'm offering isn't replacing them. AI visibility is completely different from SEO. SEO gets you ranked on Google. AI visibility gets you recommended when people ask ChatGPT or Claude for a contractor. These are two different systems. You can keep your SEO Company and add this. It was $99. You're not replacing anything you're just making sure you're visible in both places. Does that make sense?"

SCENARIO 4: "I Don't Have Time"

What she's REALLY saying: She doesn't see this as a priority. Or she doesn't understand that she doesn't have to do the work. Or she's overwhelmed and "no time" is her default response to everything.

My LPR Response: "I totally get it you're busy running a medical practice. But here's the thing: you don't need time. I need time. You give me your practice name, your website, and your payment information. That's 3 minutes. Then I do all the work. You don't have to do anything except tell me what you need. So, it's not really a time issue it's 3 minutes. What's the real concern here?"

SCENARIO 5: "I'm Not the Decision Maker"

What he's REALLY saying: He's scared to make the decision alone. Or he doesn't trust you yet. Or he's using his partner as an excuse to

stall. Or he genuinely does need to consult his partner (less common than you think for a $99 purchase).

My LPR Response: "I get it you and your partner make decisions together. But we're talking about $99 here. I'm guessing you make $100 decisions all the time without calling your partner lunch for the crew, supplies, gas for the truck, right? So, this isn't about needing approval. What's the real concern? Is it that you don't know if this will work? Is it that you don't trust me yet? Let's talk about the actual issue."

SCENARIO 6: "It Won't Work for My Industry"

What she's REALLY saying: She doesn't understand how AI works. Or she genuinely doesn't know that people are asking AI for accountant recommendations.

My LPR Response: "I hear you referrals are huge in accounting. But here's what's changing: people are asking AI for recommendations now. They're asking ChatGPT and Claude, 'Who's a good accountant near me?' And AI is giving them names. If you're not showing up in those recommendations, you're missing potential clients. This doesn't replace referrals it just makes sure you're visible when people are searching. If you can tell me one industry where people DON'T ask AI for recommendations, I'll do your audit for free. But I'm betting people are asking AI about accountants right now."

SCENARIO 7: "Send Me Information"

What he's REALLY saying: He's trying to politely get off the phone. Or he wants to delay the decision. Or he's not interested but doesn't want to say no directly.

My LPR Response:

"I could send you information, but here's what I've found: when people ask for information to review later, they never read it. Not because you're a bad person, but because you're busy. So, here's my question: what can I send you in an email that I can't answer right here in the next 5 minutes? If you have questions, let's talk through them now. And here's the other thing if you wait to call me back, I might have 20–30 audits lined up by then. You'd be waiting weeks instead of getting started in 24–48 hours. So, what's the real concern is it price, is it trust, is it something else?"

HOW'D YOU DO?

Your responses don't have to match mine word-for-word. But the core should be the same:

- You identified the REAL objection (not just the surface excuse)
- You responded to the real concern (not the fake one)
- You used LPR thinking (Listen, Process, Respond)

If you got most of these right, you're ready. If you struggled, go back and re-read the objection chapters. This is the foundation of everything. Now let's move on to the next level, adapting your approach by industry.

CHAPTER 11

Industry-Specific Variations

Opening

The same objection sounds completely different depending on who's saying it. When a lawyer says, "I need to think about it," they mean something different than when a contractor says it. When a restaurant owner says, "it's too expensive," their concerns are different from a medical practice saying the same thing. Your Listen–Process–Respond framework works universally, but the execution needs to be tailored to each industry's mindset, language, and specific pain points.

Section 1: Lawyers: The Analytical Decision-Makers

Lawyers are incredibly risk-averse and credential-focused. They think differently than other business types because everything is about liability and risk mitigation. They need extensive proof before trusting new solutions. Reputation is everything in their field. They're used to analyzing fine print and finding problems. Referrals from other lawyers carry massive weight.

When a lawyer says, "I need to think about it," they probably really do. Lawyers are analytical people who think about things before they

do them. They make calculated moves. They don't just throw caution to the wind and sign up. So, for lawyers, they really mean what they say most of the time. Your approach with lawyers should be something like: "Absolutely, you should think about it.

What specific information would help you make that decision? What questions can I answer for your analysis? Would case studies from other law firms be helpful? Do you need compliance or regulatory information?"
Instead of challenging their need to analyze, you're supporting their professional process. You're giving them the tools they need to make a calculated decision, not pressuring them to skip their natural thought process.

Call Dialogue: Robert the Pittsburgh Attorney

Here's how this plays out with an analytical lawyer:

- **Robert:** "I appreciate the call about this AI visibility audit. It's an intriguing concept, and I can see the potential value for our firm's client acquisition strategy. However, I need to conduct proper due diligence before making any commitments. Can you provide case studies from other law firms? What's your track record with legal practices specifically? I'd also need to review any compliance implications and discuss this with my partners during our monthly strategy meeting. This isn't the type of decision I make impulsively."

- **Me:** "I'm gonna keep it honest with you, Robert. We don't have a huge track record with law firms yet. But I know this is something that can help a law firm just like it helps everybody else. In fact, the first thing I studied when I started doing this was law firms. I went to Google and asked for personal injury law firms. Then I took the top 20 and went to the chatbots and said, 'Give me your top 10 law firms in this area.' And 9 times out of 10, they did not name the same law firms as Google did. So, there's a huge gap in AI visibility with law firms."
- **Robert:** "That's… that's quite revealing. A 9 out of 10 discrepancy between Google rankings and AI recommendations is significant. As attorneys, we invest heavily in SEO and Google Ads, but if potential clients are increasingly using AI to find legal representation, we could be missing a substantial market segment."
- **Me:** "Now I know a lot of times when people say they want to think about a decision, or they say they want to think about it or whatever their case may be, it's just people blowing somebody off. But I know in your situation, it's not just a blow-off. You do legitimately need to talk to some other people, and I'm fine with that. I wouldn't ask you not to. This is what you normally do in a situation like this. Treat it as normal and do what you normally need to do."

- **Robert:** "I appreciate your candor about your experience with law firms that kind of transparency builds credibility. What would be the next logical step for conducting this audit?"
- **Me:** "Well, for lawyers, since you guys have so much at stake, we recommend the premium audit. It's a 3-to-4-day turnaround. You get a 15-to-20-page PDF report back. The next step would be I send you an invoice. You pay for that and give me all your information law firm name, your area, your name, phone number, email so I can contact you. Then I'll go ahead and do the audit and record the Loom video, go through the full audit, and we'll have the half-hour call at your leisure. If you're too busy for that, we don't have to have the call it's just something I offer with these bigger reports. Whenever is good for you is when we can move on it."
- **Robert:** "The premium audit makes sense given the competitive landscape in legal services. What's the investment?"
- **Me:** "I'll need to know what area of law you practice, and your geographic area so we can check your rankings and your competitors' rankings. And the price is $299. It's a one-time price. That gets you the audit and everything that comes with it. There are no pop-up prices. There's no 'here's the audit, and for another $50 we could do this.' It doesn't work like that. We do offer implementation services, but if you have somebody that takes care of your website stuff, you can have them do that. That's totally up to you."

- **Robert:** "Perfect. $299 one-time fee with no hidden costs I appreciate the transparent pricing structure. That's exactly how we bill our clients, so I respect that approach."
- "This works because lawyers value transparency, proof, and respect for process, instead of fighting it. I was honest about my limited legal experience, showed him research I'd done specifically on law firms, and respected his need to consult partners. Lawyers appreciate transparency and thoroughness.

Section 2: Contractors: The Overwhelmed Multitaskers

Contractors are a different animal entirely. When they say they want to think about something, what they're really saying is: "I don't want to be bothered with this right now. I have too much going on." Contractors are trying to run multiple job sites, manage crews, deal with suppliers, handle customer complaints, and somehow find time to do the actual work. They're overwhelmed and juggling everything at once.

So, your approach needs to be completely different: "I don't need your help to do this. You give me the information, I'll do it, and you're free to do what you need to do. The only thing you really need to think about is: do you want the audit or not? You know you have the money in the budget. You know you have the need. You know you want to make more money and get more customers. So, there's nothing you

need to think about. How about you let me do the thinking, and you get back to running your business?"

You're removing the burden of one more thing demanding their attention. You're positioning yourself as the solution to their overwhelm not adding to it.

Section 3: Call Dialogue: Mike the HVAC Contractor

Here's the complete contrast with an overwhelmed contractor:

Mike: "Look, I'm interested in this AI thing, but honestly man, I got three jobs running behind schedule, two guys called in sick, and a customer breathing down my neck about a warranty issue. I just don't have time to think about marketing stuff right now. Can you just send me some information, and I'll look at it when I get a chance? Maybe in a couple weeks when things calm down."

Me: "You know, Mike, I would love to send you information, but I've found this: when somebody's as busy as you are, they never read it anyway. I understand you're busy, and I'm gonna leave you alone to do what you do best that's run your business. Sounds like you got jobs coming in. Sounds like you're doing great. So, here's what we do: you give me your website and the basic information I need it's like 3 or 4 questions. You pay for the audit. I'll run it and start working on getting more clients. That's what we aim for."

Mike: "Alright, you know what? That sounds perfect. I don't have time to manage another thing, and if you can just handle it all… Look, I need more calls coming in for when winter hits and HVAC work slows down. If this gets me more customers without me having to do

anything except give you my info and pay for it, let's do it. What do you need from me?" See the difference? With Mike, I didn't try to support his need to analyze like I did with Robert. I acknowledged he was busy, positioned myself as removing work from his plate, and made it completely hands-off. Contractors don't want another thing to manage they want solutions that handle themselves.

Section 4: Restaurant Owners: The Cash-Flow Conscious

Restaurants operate on razor-thin margins and are extremely cash-flow sensitive. When a restaurant owner says, "it's too expensive," they're probably thinking about how every dollar counts in their business. They're already spending on food costs, labor, and rent. Seasonal fluctuations make them nervous about new expenses. They need to see immediate ROI, not five-year projections. Your approach should focus on immediate revenue impact: "This gets you found when people search for 'restaurants near me' right now. It's $99 compared to thousands for radio ads or mailers that might not work. Get this set up before your busy season hits. One extra table per week pays for this." You're speaking their language of immediate returns and comparing your price to alternatives they already understand.

Section 5: Medical Practices: Compliance-Focused Professionals

Medical practices are heavily regulated and very risk averse. They have long decision cycles and committee-based decisions. Insurance reimbursement concerns are always present. HIPAA and compliance worries dominate their thinking. When a medical practice says "I need to talk to my partner first," they probably actually mean it. They have boards they have to answer to. They have people they need to be accountable to. They really do need partnership or committee approval for marketing decisions.

Your approach should be: "Absolutely, this is exactly the kind of decision that should be reviewed by your partners. What information would be most helpful for that discussion? Would you like me to prepare a brief overview of how this works for medical practices specifically? Are there compliance or regulatory questions I can address ahead of time?" You're supporting their legitimate decision-making process instead of challenging it. Medical practices appreciate vendors who understand their unique regulatory environment.

Section 6: Real Estate Agents: The Sales-Savvy Skeptics

I think real estate agents are a little bit harder to sell to because they're kinda salespeople themselves. So, a lot of the fancy talk and sales tricks don't work on them. They're also very time limited. Real estate agents don't have a lot of time. So, if you wanna deal with them, you gotta get to the point quickly, show them the benefits, then show them how

it's not more work on their shoulders. You gotta get in and get out with real estate agents. That's just how it is. The best way to get past all that stuff is tell them straight up: "Look, I know you're busy, I'm not gonna take a lot of your time. Let me come here, tell you what I need to tell you. You can decide if this sounds good for you or not, and then we'll figure out what we're doing from there." Real estate agents respect directness because that's how they operate. Don't try to "sell" them, just give them the facts and let them make a decision.

Section 7: Accountants/CPAs: The Number Crunchers

Accountants are number crunchers. They're more geared towards: what are the effects gonna be? What is the outcome gonna be? What's this gonna do to my bottom line? They're more worried about the math part of it. They're usually laid-back people. They'll give you a chance to say what you have to say. But they're more worried about, "What's this gonna do for me?" and "What do the numbers look like?" Your approach with accountants should focus on measurable outcomes: "This $99 audit could bring you 2–3 new clients per month. At your average client value of $2,000 annually, that's $4,000–$6,000 in additional revenue. The ROI is 40–60 to 1 in the first year alone." Give them the numbers they can plug into their own calculations.

Show them exactly how the investment pays for itself and generates profit.

Section 8: Learning to Adapt: The Lawyer Lesson

Recently, I've been dealing with a lawyer, and that's when I realized that lawyers are a different breed than other people. I gotta watch very closely what I say, what I do, what I promise. Make sure that everything I say I can do can be shown and proven. Don't ever make false promises or overstate capabilities. I was getting ready to send out cold emails, and I looked at this cold email that ChatGPT helped me write. Right in the email, it says, "Look, I'm not selling anything." And I went to ChatGPT and said, "What do you mean we're not selling anything? You can't say I'm not selling anything and then when you talk to them, turn around and say, 'Hey, do you wanna buy a $299 audit?' That doesn't make any sense." I had to change that real quick. That's when it hit me with lawyers, every word matters. They analyze everything for inconsistencies and contradictions. You can't use vague language or make claims you can't back up. They'll spot it immediately and it destroys your credibility.

Section 9: Reading the Room: Responding to Their Energy

I'll be honest, I just go to each person and I kind of respond to how they act. If they come across as real stuffy, then I kind of change my

attitude to match that. If they come across as laid back, I relax a little bit. I try to mirror their personality and their attitude when I'm selling to them. If someone sounds formal and professional, I match that energy with more structured language and detailed explanations. If they're casual and direct, I drop the formalities and get straight to the point. If they seem analytical, I slow down and provide more data. If they seem overwhelmed, I simplify and remove complexity.

The key is listening not just to their words, but to their tone, pace, and overall energy. Are they rushing? Then you tighten your pitch. Are they asking detailed questions? You give them thorough answers. Are they using industry jargon? You speak their language back to them. Don't try to force your natural communication style on everyone. Adapt to theirs, and they'll feel more comfortable working with you.

Closing: Master the Psychology, Learn the Language

Whether you're talking to lawyers, contractors, restaurant owners, medical practices, real estate agents, or accountants, the Listen–Process–Respond framework never changes. But your execution must adapt to each industry's specific psychology, language, and concerns.

- A lawyer needs detailed analysis and proof.
- A contractor needs simple efficiency and no additional burden.
- A restaurant owner needs immediate ROI and cash-flow consciousness.

- A medical practice needs compliance assurance and committee respect.
- A real estate agent needs no nonsense directness and time efficiency.
- An accountant needs clear numbers and bottom-line impact.

The biggest mistake salespeople make is using a one-size-fits all approach. They learn one script and try to force it on everyone. But "I need to think about it" means completely different things coming from different people. Your response should match their industry mindset, not your comfort zone.

Master the psychology first, then learn each industry's language. Understand their unique pressures, decision-making processes, and communication preferences. Mirror their energy and adapt your approach in real time.

When you can speak to a lawyer like a legal professional, a contractor like a practical problem-solver, and an accountant like a number-focused analyst, you become unstoppable across all business types. The framework stays the same. The execution makes all the difference.

Industry Adaptation Practice

You've learned how to handle objections. Now you need to learn how to adapt your approach based on who you're talking to. The same objection means different things coming from a lawyer versus a contractor versus a restaurant owner. Your response needs to match their industry psychology, not just repeat the same script.

Here's how this works: I'm going to give you the SAME objection from 5 different industries. For each one, write down how you'd adapt your response based on what you learned in Chapter 11.
THE OBJECTION: "I need to think about it."

SCENARIO 1: LAWYER

A personal injury lawyer says: "I appreciate the information about AI visibility, but I need to think this through carefully. This is the kind of decision I need to analyze before committing to anything."

How do you adapt your response for a LAWYER?

SCENARIO 2: CONTRACTOR

An HVAC contractor says: "Look, I'm interested, but I got three jobs running behind and a crew that's short-staffed. I need some time to think about whether I can even deal with this right now."

How do you adapt your response for a CONTRACTOR?

SCENARIO 3: RESTAURANT OWNER

The restaurant owner says: "This sounds good, but I need to think about whether we can fit this into the budget. Money's tight right now with food costs going up."

How do you adapt your response for a RESTAURANT OWNER?

SCENARIO 4: REAL ESTATE AGENT

A real estate agent says: "Yeah, I've heard about this AI stuff. Let me think about it and I'll get back to you if I'm interested."

How do you adapt your response for a REAL ESTATE AGENT?

SCENARIO 5: ACCOUNTANT

An accountant says: "I'd need to see the numbers on this before making a decision. Let me think about the ROI and I'll let you know."

How do you adapt your response for an ACCOUNTANT?

Don't look at the answer key until you've written responses for all 5 industries.

ANSWER KEY: HOW TO ADAPT BY INDUSTRY

SCENARIO 1: LAWYER

The Adaptation: Lawyers are analytical and risk-averse. When they say "I need to think about it," they probably actually mean it. Don't challenge their need to analyze support it.

My Response: "Absolutely, you should think this through that's smart. Let me help with your analysis. What specific information would be most useful? Would case studies from other law firms help? Do you need to see data on AI search behavior? Or is there a compliance or risk question I can address? I want to give you exactly what you need to make a confident decision."

Why this works: You're respecting their analytical process instead of fighting it. You're positioning yourself as helping them make a smart decision, not pressuring them into a hasty one.

SCENARIO 2: CONTRACTOR

The Adaptation: Contractors are overwhelmed. "I need to think about it" usually means "I don't have bandwidth for one more thing." Remove the burden.

My Response: "I totally get it you're slammed. But here's the thing: you don't need time to think about this. You need me to handle it. You give me your business info and your payment it takes 3 minutes. Then I do all the work. You don't have to manage it, you don't have

to think about it, you don't have to do anything. I handle it and get you more customers. So it's not really about time you're not adding work to your plate. What's the real concern?"

Why this works: You're positioning yourself as removing a burden, not adding one. Contractors respect people who understand they're busy and don't waste their time.

SCENARIO 3: RESTAURANT OWNER

The Adaptation: Restaurant owners operate on razor-thin margins. "Think about the budget" means they need to see immediate ROI in simple terms.

My Response: "I hear you on the budget every dollar matters in a restaurant. But let's think about this differently. This is $99 one time. If this gets you just one extra table per week one that's probably $100–$200 in revenue. So, it pays for itself with one table. After that, everything else is profit. You're not spending $99 you're investing $99 to make thousands. When you look at it that way, can you really afford NOT to do this?"

Why this works: You're speaking their language immediate, tangible ROI in terms they understand (tables, not abstract marketing metrics).

SCENARIO 4: REAL ESTATE AGENT

The Adaptation: Real estate agents are sales-savvy and hate being sold to. They're also extremely time limited. Cut the BS and get to the point.

My Response: "Look, I know you're busy and I'm not gonna blow smoke. Here's the deal: people are asking AI for real estate agent recommendations right now. If you're not showing up, you're losing leads. This is $99 to make sure you're visible. It takes 3 minutes to set up. You in or out?"

Why this works: You're treating them like a fellow salesperson direct, no fluff, respecting their time. Real estate agents appreciate when you don't try to "sell" them.

SCENARIO 5: ACCOUNTANT

The Adaptation: Accountants are number-driven. Give them exact ROI calculations and let them run the math themselves.

My Response: "Absolutely, let's look at the numbers. This audit is $99 one time. If it brings you 2–3 new clients per month, and your average client is worth $2,000 annually, that's $4,000–$6,000 in additional revenue per year. So your ROI is 40–60 to 1 in year one. After that, it's pure profit with no additional cost. Run those numbers and tell me if that makes sense for your practice."

Why this works: You're giving them the exact calculation they need. Accountants respect concrete numbers, not vague promises.

Closing:

Same objection. Five completely different responses. That's what industry adaptation looks like. If you're giving the same pitch to everyone, you're leaving money on the table. Match your response to

their psychology, their language, and their concerns. Now let's talk about building your confidence to actually do this work.

CHAPTER 12

Teaching Others To Handle Objections

Opening

Most sales training fails because it treats objection handling like a textbook subject instead of a skill that requires practice and adaptation. You can give someone a script for every possible objection, but the moment a customer throws them a curveball, they freeze. The difference between textbook training and system training is simple: Textbooks give you answers to known questions. Systems give you a framework for handling unknown situations.

Section 1: The Mindset Shift: "Get the Solution," Not "Get the Sale"

Before you can teach anyone to handle objections effectively, you need to fundamentally change how they think about sales conversations. Most people approach sales with one goal: to close the deal. Get the signature. Make the sale. That mindset creates desperate, manipulative salespeople who push products people don't need and feel terrible about their work. The mindset you need to teach is this: Your job isn't to get the sale. Your job is to get the solution. To figure out what problem the customer actually has and whether you can

solve it. When you shift from "get the sale" to "get the solution," everything changes.

Objections stop being obstacles and start being information.
The customer isn't fighting you, they're telling you what they need to hear to make a confident decision. Most sales training teaches you to "overcome objections" like their barriers between you and the commission check. But objections aren't barriers. Their guideposts show you exactly where the customer needs help.

Section 2: Taking Responsibility for Real Sales Success

It's also about taking responsibility for your sales. When you use this approach and you really listen to customers, when you get a sale, it's because you did something right:

- You solved their actual problem.
- You understood their real concern.
- You addressed it effectively.

The old way where you're just bullying people into buying, when you get a sale, all it really means is you beat them down enough that they relented.

Hooray. Let's celebrate. But there's no skill in that. There's no pride in that. And there's no repeat business or referrals from that. Taking responsibility for your sales means: If you didn't get the sale, maybe you didn't listen well enough Maybe you didn't understand their real

problem Maybe you offered the wrong solution Maybe they genuinely weren't a good fit It's about skill development, not just toughness or persistence.

Section 3: Quick Qualification: The 2–3 Minute Assessment

Here's something you need to keep in mind when you go into every sales meeting: There's a chance this person might not need what you have to sell. They honestly might not. We're not going to waste our time. We're going to evaluate, in the first 2–3 minutes of a conversation, if that person really needs our product or not. And if you can tell this person really doesn't need this product, then you should say: "Hey, you know what? I'm with you on this one. I don't think you need this product. So I'm going to let you go. Have a nice day. Have a great weekend."

Say you sell prosthetics for a living. You call up a guy who has two arms and two legs. You think if you spend an hour on the phone with him, you're going to change his mind? He doesn't need prosthetic. Cut your losses. Move on to someone that needs your service or your product. For Algorithm Collective, if I call a restaurant owner and in the first two minutes, he tells me he doesn't have a website, I really don't have a reason to keep pressing him for the AIO sale. Now do I try to sell him a website? Hell yeah, I try to sell him the website because now I've identified a need. But the AIO audit? No. He doesn't

need that. If he doesn't have a website, there's no reason for the audit. This teaches people to be efficient, ethical, and effective all at once.

Section 4: The Old-School Approach vs. The Ethical Approach

Most of the time in sales, the ultimate "no" is right in their hand. If you're on the phone with somebody, the ultimate "no" is they hang up. If they're still talking to you, there's a reason they're still on the phone. The old-school way of teaching says: just keep pushing them. Get more aggressive until you bully them into a sale. Do you think they feel good about that afterwards? You shouldn't. When you use the new approach, when you really listen, qualify, and solve real problems if you get a sale, it's because you did something right. The old way, where you're just bullying people into buying, and you get a sale, all that means is you beat them down until they give up. That's not sales. That's just pressure.

Section 5: AI Role-Playing: The Practice Method That Actually Works

When I genuinely had my biggest breakthrough that revolutionized this whole thing for me, it was when I was talking to AI. So, I think your best way to role-play, honestly, is with your AI assistant. I'm a Claude fan Claude is the way to go. It's super easy to set up:

- Download Claude on your phone.

- Open a window.
- Say: "Hey, Claude. I want to practice my sales approach. Can you give me some objections?"

That was my exact prompt. And I'll tell you what it wasn't just the objections that did it. It was me feeling comfortable enough that I was with AI that changed and radicalized my whole way of thinking.
I was literally sitting there saying: "Claude, can you give me one more objection? "Claude, okay just one more after this…" I couldn't get enough. I found myself asking for more objections repeatedly because the practice was finally clicking The AI practice environment creates that breakthrough because you feel safe enough to discover your natural talent. No judgment, No pressure, Just pure practice until you find your rhythm For training others, this is revolutionary.

Instead of awkward role-plays with coworkers in conference rooms, have your team practice with AI assistants. They can: Practice more frequently Build confidence without embarrassment Work through scenarios until they genuinely feel solid

Section 6: Teaching Sarah to Handle "I Need to Think About It”

Here's what it looks like when you're actually training someone on objection handling:

- **Sarah (new salesperson):** "Ben, I keep getting stuck when people say they need to think about it. I don't know what to

say back. Yesterday a business owner said that and I just said 'okay, I'll call you next week' and hung up. I feel like I'm losing every sale because I don't know how to respond to objections. Can you help me practice this?"

- **Me:** "This is one of the harder ones to handle, Sarah, because 'I need to think about it' could mean they're not interested. It could mean they're just trying to delay. It can mean a lot of different things. Basically, your goal is to pull out what they really mean."
- **Sarah:** "Okay, so I need to figure out what they really mean. But how do I do that without sounding pushy?"
- **Me:** "That's where your rebuttal comes in. When they say 'I need to think about it,' you're gonna question them. You say: 'What is it that you need to think about that I can't go over with you on the phone right now in the next 10–15 minutes? I've got 15 minutes, what do you need to think about?' You're gonna push them to either say, 'Okay, I didn't need to think about anything, I was just trying to get off the phone.' Or you're gonna push them to tell you what they really need to think about. Either way, if they give you an answer, now you have something you can work with."
- **Sarah:** "What do they usually say when I push them like that?"
- **Me:** "When you press them, they're gonna give you a real reason. And yeah, crazily enough, when you ask them what they're thinking about, usually they're gonna say: 'Well, there

wasn't anything I really needed to think about. I was just trying to get off the phone.'

Or: 'This is what I need to think about…' And a lot of times, it'll come down to:

- 'I don't know your company.'
- 'I don't know who you are.'
- 'I don't really trust you yet.'

That's what it is most of the time. Another big one is the brush-off: 'I said I need to think about it because I didn't want to get into it right now. I'm busy.' Either way, once they tell you, you can handle the real issue instead of the fake one."

- **Sarah:** "So how do I handle the brush-off versus the trust issue?"
- **Me:** "If they tell you, it was a brush-off, say: 'You know what? It's only going to take about 5–10 minutes. Let me tell you what I have to offer, and then you can decide if you want to check it out or not.' If they tell you, 'I don't know your company,' that's when you say: 'Here's the deal. We work with this person, this person, and this person. I can give you company names, numbers, people to call, places to look us up. I understand you don't know us from anywhere, so I can give you plenty of information that will help you decide if we're a reputable company or not.'"
- **Sarah:** "This is so much better than just accepting 'I need to think about it' and losing the sale!"

This approach works because it forces the real concern to surface. You walk them through the logic, show them specific responses, and help them understand why the approach works.
That's system training, not script memorization.

Section 7: Measuring Success, the Right Way

Most companies measure sales training success by one thing: have sales figures go up? But that's the wrong metric when you're teaching the "get the solution" approach. Here's what you should measure:

- **Customer Satisfaction:** Do customers feel heard and understood? Would they recommend your salesperson to others?
- **Repeat Business and Referrals:** Do customers come back for more services? Are they referring to friends and colleagues? Are they expanding the relationship?
- **Salesperson Job Satisfaction:** Do your salespeople feel good about their work? Are they proud of how they help customers? Do they look forward to sales calls instead of dreading them?
- **Quality of Conversations:** Are calls getting longer because customers want to talk? Are customers asking more questions and engaging more? Are salespeople walking away from bad fits professionally?

When you measure these things, you'll find that sales numbers improve naturally but as a byproduct of doing the right thing for customers, not as the only goal.

Section 8: The Real-World Example: Turning "No" Into Bigger Opportunities

I called a restaurant owner about an AIO audit. In the first two minutes, he tells me he doesn't have a website. Traditional sales would call that a failed call: no AIO sale, move on. But I listen to what he needs. I say: "You're right you don't need the AIO audit. But you know what you might need? A website. We build websites too." I turned that "no" which would have gone in the sales book as a negative into a full potential website build worth $2,500–$5,000, off a $99 audit conversation. Traditional sales would call me a failure. I didn't make the AIO sale.

But in reality, I made a sale that was 25 to 50 times more profit than what I set out to do. And that all came down to customer satisfaction:

- I listened to the customer
- I was honest that they didn't need my product
- I heard their real problem
- I solved their real problem
- And I made a bigger, better sale

This is exactly what you need to teach: when you measure problem-solving instead of just "did they buy what you originally offered," you create salespeople who find bigger opportunities by helping people.

Section 9: The Biggest Mistakes New Salespeople Make

Many new salespeople make a lot of mistakes, but the good news is they can start tomorrow and be successful. They just need to learn. One of the biggest mistakes? They give in too easily. The goal isn't to trap people in conversations it's to make sure you don't walk away before understanding what they actually need. A person says, "Oh, I'm not interested," and they go, "Okay, thank you for your time." But most of the time when people say they're not interested, they don't really mean they're not interested. Now, you don't want to be that old-school salesperson who has somebody on the phone crying because you won't let them off. But you also don't want to be a pushover, because then you're never going to get any sales.

I think the biggest thing a new salesperson can learn that will really help them is: Stop taking objections personally. Literally, that's the biggest one. When somebody's giving you an objection, they're not telling you no. They're saying: "I'm not there yet. There's still something in my head that needs solved and I'm not ready yet." As soon as you figure out what it is in their head that needs solved, you're

gonna be good. They're going to jump on that sale. Objections are just them saying:
"I got a hang-up and I need help solving this hang-up. I need you to help me give myself permission to go through with this." That's all objections are. They're good things. Objections are another chance. Instead of them saying no and hanging up, they're giving you an objection and giving you another shot to get it right. So, take it for what it is a blessing.

Closing: Building Real Sales Professionals

Teaching others to handle objections isn't about memorizing scripts or learning manipulation tactics. It's about developing genuine problem-solving skills and the confidence to have real conversations with people who need help. When you teach the "get the solution" mindset instead of "get the sale," you create salespeople who actually enjoy their work. They stop dreading objections and start seeing them as opportunities to help customers make better decisions.

The Listen–Process–Respond framework works because it's based on human psychology, not sales tricks. People want to be heard and understood before they make decisions. When you teach your team to truly listen, process what customers are really saying, and respond to their actual concerns, you build trust that leads to long-term business relationships.
Remember: Objections are not rejections. They're requests for help. Train your people to see them that way, and you'll transform not just

their sales numbers, but their entire approach to serving customers. The best salespeople aren't the pushiest or the most persistent.

They're the best listeners, the ones who can quickly identify real problems and offer genuine solutions. That's what this book teaches. And that's what you should be teaching others.

Start with the mindset. Build the skills. Practice with AI until it becomes natural. And always remember: When you help customers solve their real problems, the sales take care of themselves.

CHAPTER 13

The 7 Deadly Sins

- Harass them until they hang up
- Script worship
- Commission scams
- Bully management culture
- Everyone is a prospect
- Manipulation over value
- Always be closing

Opening

This is the chapter we call The 7 Deadly Sins. These are 7 major sales ideas from the past that are very toxic but keep getting regurgitated year after year when they're teaching new people sales. We need to finally put these to bed and get rid of these 7 deadly sins.

Section 1: Deadly Sin #1: Harass Them Until They Hang Up

Alright. In our chapter of deadly sins, we're gonna start with the first one, that age-old teaching: Harass them until they hang up. That's

what these old-school training managers tell you: "Keep going. Just keep going." You're trying to sell somebody something. They're telling you they don't need it. They're telling you they don't want it. But your sales manager is making you push them to the point where they feel like the only way out is to hang up on you. That ruins any relationship you have with this client.

What you need to do is:

- You get on the phone with them.
- You talk to them like a human being.
- Within the first 2 minutes, you qualify.

Qualify that:

- There's a need for what you sell
- This is something they could use
- It's a product they want or a process they need

Once you decide this is something they need, you qualify them, and then you go to LPR:

- Listen
- Process
- Respond

You listen to their objections. You process that in your head. You respond to them in a way that solves the puzzle in their brain that's stopping them from buying. Because what they say might not be what they mean. They might say, "I don't have time right now," but what they're really saying is, "Hey, I don't know you," or "I don't trust this yet." We don't want to burn this lead so badly that they never want to

speak to us again because some slimy old-school sales manager made you run the relationship into the ground.

They say, "I'm sorry, I really don't need this." And you say, "Well, I understand what you're saying, but can we get you signed up?" No. You don't understand. If you understood, you'd stop asking them the same question over and over.
So instead of burning it harassing them until they hang up it's simple: Call them

Step 1: Qualify

If you can't qualify, let them go It's like fishing. If you can't catch that monster fish, sometimes you gotta let that monster fish go for another day, until you have better bait and a better rod. If you can qualify them, go ahead. Go through the objections. Use LPR. Maybe you solve that problem in their head and make the sale. But sometimes they're gonna say, "Hey. I just don't need this right now."
And you're gonna say: "You know what? I respect that." That respect goes a long way. They might not buy from you today, but they might buy from you:

- Next week
- Next month
- Next year

They might refer you to a family member, a friend, or a coworker. All of that leads to sales. But when you follow that lesson harass them

until they hang up you push and push and push until they slam the phone in your ear, it pisses them off, it ruins the relationship, and it hurts you in the future. We need to stop harassing until they hang up.

Section 2: Deadly Sin #2: Script Worship

Deadly sin number 2 is script worship.

Like I said that home improvement Company I worked at was deadly sin bingo. Script worship is this outdated idea that your job is to just read the script. They've built you this "perfect" script, and your main job is to read it, word for word, no matter what the customer says. That's not true. Your real job is to reach out to the customer on a human level and get them excited about what you're selling. Don't let script worship turn you into a robot that just keeps pummeling them:

- "I understand, but…"
- "I understand, but…"
- "I understand, but…"

You don't understand, or you'd actually address what they just said. If you understood, you'd listen, process, and respond.

So, script worship deadly sin number 2 we need to put this to bed. Throw it out the window. If you know what you're selling, talk to your client one-on-one. Forget reading the script like a robot. Figure out the problems they're having. Solve those problems. Get the sale. Move on to the next client.

Now let's look at it from another angle.

You go through your script, and you ask somebody:

- "Hey, are you interested in this?"

They say:

- "No. I really don't have any need for this."

Script worship pushes you to say:

- "Well, I understand you don't have any need, but here's two or three more points… can we sign you up?"

They say:

- "I'm sorry, I don't have any need for this." And you ignore them again, give them a couple more points, and ask for the sale again. That doesn't work. That's just as bad as deadly sin #1.

Instead, you:

- Call them
- Qualify them
- Use LPR

When they say to you, "I don't need this," you figure out if they really don't need it. Maybe you're selling cable and they tell you they don't have a TV in their house. What are you gonna say to get them to buy cable with no TV? How are you going to script-worship your way out of that? "Well, I understand you don't have a TV, but man, this cable is a really good deal!" They're not going to say: "You know what, pal? The deal is so great that I'll take it, even though I can't watch it." No. Script worship isn't getting you out of that.

What works is: "You don't have a TV? You hit the nail on the head you really don't need cable if you don't have a TV. But I appreciate you for taking the time today." Now, three weeks down the road, when he does go out and buy a TV, what's he going to do?

He's going to say: "Hey, that guy Ben called and offered me cable. I didn't have a TV then. I got a TV now. Maybe I should give him a call and see what that deal was all about." By not worshiping the script, by being a human being, you still get that sale down the road or a referral. You treated the client like a human being, not a target for rebuttals. That's why we need to get rid of script worship.

Section 3: Deadly Sin #3: Commission Scams

Deadly sin number 3 is the commission scam.

I'm sure a lot of people have been through this. I used to work at a home improvement company. I remember when I got my first sale. I was excited because you got a piece of that sale.
I couldn't wait. I'd been there about two weeks. I did everything I was supposed to. I go into the office and I ask about the sale and when we get paid for it. The manager looks at me and says: "Oh, sorry, buddy. That sale never went through." I look over at the board and there it is, big as day, written on the board: The customer's name 30K sale my name isn't written there, but I know that's the customer I closed.

He says: "Yeah, they backed out. I'm sorry. This happens sometimes." And the thing is, you really don't have any way to prove if they're lying or not. Except in my case, I went in the office, and it was still on the board. I knew it was a lie. That was when I decided to quit. Like I said, this place was deadly sin heaven bully management, commission scam, script worship, all of it. It was deadly sin bingo every day. You get into one of those boiler-room, backroom operations where they treat you like that? Best thing you can do is get out as fast as you can.

There are places that will appreciate your talent. In those scummy places, you're just a number. You're just a seat that fills an autodialer. So, if you get any wind of a commission scam deadly sin number 3 soon as you smell it, just get out. It's not going to be worth working there. Start looking for somewhere else immediately.

Section 4: Deadly Sin #4: Bully Management Culture

Next is deadly sin number 4: bully management culture.

Like I said, that home improvement company I worked at was deadly sin bingo. I worked there with a guy named John Rebel. He was what you'd call the boss of bullies. If there was a PlayStation game about bullying, he'd be the final boss. He worked with his younger brother, and he would scream at this kid in front of everybody and make him look like a fool. One day, he got it into his head that he didn't like something I did. He came out onto the floor and called me out in front of everyone.

I said: "Can I talk to you in your office?" He just looked at me like I was nuts. But he said, "Yeah, let's go." We went to his office. I shut the door and told him: "Listen to me."

He's looking at me like I'm crazy, because people usually cowered from him. I said: "There is one person on this entire earth who has the right to talk to me the way you're talking to me. And that's my mother. Because she gave birth to me. She can talk to me that way and I'm going to take it.

There is nobody else I'm taking that from. And that includes you.

So, if you have something you want to say to me, you can yell at me, you can do whatever but you're gonna bring me into your office, you're gonna close this door, and that's where you're going to do it. You're not gonna try to make a fool out of me in front of everyone. I've shown you all the respect in the world since I met you. And I am not going to work under bully management culture. This is how it's gonna be. You get one warning. Next time it happens, I'm out the door." And here's the crazy part the impression that conversation left on him was wild.

The respect he showed me after that was unbelievable. He treated me like a human being. He would still yell at everybody else daily. But I promise you, he never once screamed at me again. If he had a problem with my work, he'd call me in the office, I'd shut the door, he'd tell me what the issue was, we'd fix it. He'd say, "Alright, Ben, thanks." I'd say, "Alright, John." And I'd go back to work. Never another issue.

So just know when that bully management culture shows up, nip it in the bud. Right away.

There is no job that pays enough to let people treat you like garbage. Unless they're handing you a million dollars a year, as soon as they start that bully stuff, you walk out the door or you shut it down like I did.

Section 5: Deadly Sin #5: Everyone Is a Prospect

Next up, deadly sin number 5:

"Everyone is a prospect." As the great chef Gordon Ramsay would say: that's bollocks, mate. Obviously, if you're selling prosthetics fake arms and legs and you call up a guy with two arms and two legs, no amount of talking in the world is going to get this guy to buy an arm or a leg. He doesn't need one. So no, not everyone is a prospect. This is where you must qualify. You gotta:

- Listen to what they're saying
- Make sure they really are a prospect
- Make sure they need what you're selling

Maybe when they say they don't need it... they really don't need it. Old-school sales teaches you: go for the sale no matter what.

Let me give you a great example. Say I call someone and I'm going for an AIO sale. I ask them about their online presence and they tell me: "I don't have a website." Now, I can continue to argue with them

about how they "still need this." But let's be honest they don't need the AIO audit if they don't even have a website.

The smart move is this:

- They don't need the AIO.
- They do need a website.

Traditional sales would say my job was to sell them the AIO. I didn't, so I failed. But I called them, used my LPR process, and realized I'm out here trying to sell them a $99 AIO when I can sell them a website for $3–5K. So I flip the script. He doesn't need the AIO, but he does need a website. I explain what a website can do for him. Say I end up getting the website sale for $5,000. Conventional sales would say: "He lost that call. He didn't sell the AIO." But let's be honest: I sold him a website for $5,000 That's 50 times the value of the AIO Who lost? I didn't lose. The customer didn't lose he got what he needed. The only thing that I lost was old-school sales theory.

Section 6: Deadly Sin #6: Manipulation Over Value

Number 6 is manipulation over value.

This is that old-school tactic of generating fake urgency and fear: "This sale ends tonight. If you don't get it right now, you'll never see this price again." "Don't you want what's best for your family?" The classic bait and switch.

The whole mindset is:

- "If I can find the right button to push, I can sell anybody anything."

- If I can find that fear in them and push on it, they'll buy.

What I offer with my AIO service is the exact opposite: value. $99 versus thousands a month in SEO fees a path to being recommended by AI tools instead of paying insane ad bills let me give you a prime example of manipulation overvalue. When I worked at Reese Brothers Telemarketing, I worked on a campaign selling credit card insurance. You had to stick to that script like your life depended on it. They literally monitored lines to make sure you never went off it.

God forbid you ever admit to somebody: "You know what, buddy? You probably don't need this." If you said that, they'd drag you into a smoky back room, tell you how terrible you were at sales, and preach about "creating fear" in the customer. One day, I'm on a call selling credit card protection. The man on the other end tells me he has AIDS and has nurses coming in every day to take care of him. What does the script tell me to say? "Well, since you have nurses coming in and out of your home that proves you need this even more. You need to keep these numbers safe.

" This poor man goes out to his car, gets his credit card, comes back inside, and reads me the numbers to sign up for credit card protection for $13 a month. I had never gotten a sale I felt worse about in my life. Here's this guy, dying of an illness. And I'm preying on his fear to sell him credit card insurance he doesn't truly need. All for $13 a month. That was my last day at Reese Brothers Telemarketing. I didn't want to be involved with that anymore. I didn't feel like I made a decent buck that day. I felt like I ripped somebody off and scared

them into buying something. I don't ever want to be part of that again. And neither should you.

Section 7: Deadly Sin #7: Always Be Closing

Here we are. Deadly sin number 7:

ABC – Always Be Closing. That old mentality that every conversation must end with you asking for the close.

We're past that. It doesn't work anymore. It frustrates people when:

- You don't give them space
- You don't build a relationship
- You just shout statistics and shove your pitch at them over and over
- When all you care about is forcing information into their head and forcing a decision, it's not going to work.

You don't always need to be closing.

You need to:

- Give them the information
- Use LPR: Listen, Process, Respond
- Let them come to their own decision

When they come to their own decision, they feel better about it. It cuts down on refunds and buyer's remorse. Our system isn't ABC. It's LPR.

You:

- Listen
- Process
- Respond

You help them make the right decision for themselves. That’s the new model.

Closing

These 7 deadly sins have poisoned the sales industry for decades. They: Turning salespeople into predators Turn customers into victims create adversarial relationships instead of collaborative partnerships Give honest salespeople a bad name It's time to put these toxic practices to bed once and for all. The new way of sales is simple:
Listen to people

- Understand their real problems
- Provide genuine solutions
- Build relationships based on trust and value not manipulation and pressure

When you focus on helping people instead of extracting money from them, sales become easier, customers become happier, and you can sleep well at night knowing you're making the world a little bit better instead of worse. That's the future of sales. And it starts with burying these 7 deadly sins forever.

CHAPTER 14

Building Confidence In New Salespeople

Opening

When I first got into sales, I was terrified. My very first sales job was doing nonprofit telemarketing, and I'll never forget my first rejection. I called someone asking for a donation, gave them my pitch, and they just said, "no," and hung up. My heart was racing. I thought I'd done something wrong, like I'd personally offended them somehow. Looking back now, I realize how normal that was but at that moment, it felt like the end of the world. That fear is what stops most people from ever getting good at sales. They take that first rejection personally, and it crushes their confidence before they even get started. But here's what I've learned: building confidence in sales isn't about never getting rejected. It's about learning how to handle rejection without letting it destroy you.

Section 1: The Toxic Training Problem

The real tragedy is how many sales organizations actively destroy new salespeople's confidence instead of building it up. I've seen firsthand training programs that throw new people into the deep end with no support, managers who yell at you for not hitting numbers without teaching you how to actually sell, and compensation structures

designed to keep you desperate and afraid. I remember working at one place where the sales manager was, this guy named John Rebel. Total bully. He'd stand behind you while you were on calls and literally yell at you if he didn't like what you were saying. Imagine trying to build confidence when someone's breathing down your neck, criticizing every word out of your mouth. It was psychological warfare disguised as "training."

The worst part was the commission structure. They'd promise you big money "make $60,000 your first year!" but the actual commission plan was designed so you could never hit those numbers. They'd change the rules, move the goalposts find reasons to deny your commissions. I watched good salespeople quit because they couldn't feed their families, even though they were making sales. That's not training. That's exploitation. And it creates the opposite of confidence it creates fear, desperation, and burnout.

Section 2: Standing Up for Yourself

I'll never forget the day I stood up to John Rebel. He was doing his usual routine, standing behind me while I was on a call, getting ready to criticize. I was in the middle of talking to a prospect when he leaned

in and started whispering corrections in my ear. I couldn't focus on the call, couldn't think straight, and I ended up losing the sale. After I hung up, he started going off on me about how I'd blown it, how I wasn't listening to his coaching, how I'd never make it in sales. Something in me just snapped. I stood up, looked him in the eye, and said, "You want to know why I lost that sale? Because you were in my ear the entire time.

How am I supposed to focus on the customer when you're distracting me?" The room went silent. Nobody talked back to John Rebel. But I was done. I was done with being treated like garbage while making money for someone else. That moment taught me something crucial about confidence: sometimes you must stand up for yourself, even when it's scary, even when there are consequences. John backed off after that. Not because he respected me guys like him don't respect anyone but because he realized I wasn't going to be his punching bag anymore. And you know what? My sales actually improved once he stopped breathing down my neck. Turns out confidence comes from being treated like a human being, not like a number on a spreadsheet.

Section 3: Finding the Right Environment

After I left that toxic place, I made a promise to myself: I'd never work somewhere that treated people like that again. I started looking for companies that actually cared about developing their salespeople, places that understood that confident salespeople sell more than desperate, afraid ones. The difference was night and day. At reputable companies, they invest in training. Real training, not just throwing you on the phones and hoping you figure it out. They teach you the product, the objections you'll face, and how to handle them. They give you scripts to start with, then help you develop your own style. They treat rejection as a learning opportunity, not a personal failure.

More importantly, they create compensation structures that actually reward performance. When you know you'll get paid fairly for your work, when you're not worried about commissions being denied for arbitrary reasons, you can focus on doing the job well instead of just surviving. That's when I started to build real confidence. Not the fake bravado that comes from desperation, but genuine confidence based on competence and fair treatment.

Section 4: Building the Right Culture at Algorithm Collective

When I started building Algorithm Collective, I thought a lot about those early sales experiences. I remembered what it felt like to be the new person, terrified of making mistakes, unsure if I was doing it right.

I remembered the toxic managers and the exploitative commission structures. And I decided: Algorithm Collective would be different. If I'm going to build a sales team, I'm going to build one based on respect, honest training, and fair compensation. No yelling. No psychological games. No commission scams. Just real training, real support, and real opportunity.

That starts with teaching people the right way to sell the ethical way. The Listen, Process, Respond framework I've talked about throughout this book isn't just a sales technique. It's a confidence-building tool. When you know you're treating people honestly, when you know you're actually trying to help them solve problems instead of manipulating them into buying, it changes everything. You can make calls without that sick feeling in your stomach. You can handle objections without feeling like a con artist. You can sleep at night knowing you did right by people.

Section 5: Building Confidence Before the Call

Before I do something that scares me, I draw on experience from my rap music days. I used to get on stage and perform literal songs and dance in front of crowds. That taught me something crucial about confidence. Before you get on with a sales call, just remember it's just a phone call. If you don't get the sale, there's another phone call right after it. You can try again. Don't beat yourself up for getting something wrong. You're going to make mistakes. You're going to say things that sound silly. My grandfather taught me something when I

was younger that's stayed with me my whole life. It's been my life mantra ever since.

One time, I was helping him with dishes and I broke one. My dad was very abusive, so when I broke that dish, I was terrified. I started crying instantly, freaking out. My grandfather said, “Whoa, whoa, calm down.” I'm apologizing like crazy, and he looked at me and said: "The only man that doesn't make a mistake is the man that doesn't help at all." He was saying I came from a place of goodness, trying to help put dishes away. I broke one it's not a big deal. I learned from that great man that day not to be afraid to put myself out there. Because the man who never puts himself out there never makes mistakes, but he also never amounts to anything either.

Section 6: The Mindset Shift: From Victim to Boss

Here's the thing things usually don't go my way, and that's one of the biggest hurdles you're going to run into in sales or anything else. Every time something happens to you, if you let that get into your head, you're going to stay in a state of perpetual chaos. We don't do that. What we do is use the same process as our sales approach Listen, Process, Respond. When something goes wrong, there's not really a listen part, but you must process and respond. You get through your head that this isn't a big deal. This isn't the end of the world. No matter what happens, there's something waiting for you on the other side of this. You go handle that shit like a boss. Period.

You say, "Yeah, I know that last call went horrible, but you know what? I don't care. On to the next call. This next call is going to be different because I'm going to make it different." Start writing about your destiny. Don't just let destiny happen. Start writing your own destiny. Stop letting these other chumps write your destiny. Write your own life story. Don't live by reacting to what goes on. Make stuff happen. That's how you deal with setbacks by making things happen.

Section 7: The Moment I Decided I Was Done

You know what moment I pushed against the grain and said, "the hell with this, I'm going for it"? It was literally this whole thing making Algorithm Collective, writing this book, everything. I was standing at my dead-end job one day, and Chuck had pissed me off again for some unknown reason. I can't remember why. But it hit me: What are you doing with your life, man? That's when I decided to sit down and create Algorithm Collective. I sat down with my AI assistant Claude, and we worked through a couple of things. We started thinking about apps now I have 3–4 apps in the works. The AI audits, this book, and I'm on my way out of here.

I wouldn't be where I am now because this place just doesn't deserve me, to be honest. I'm not trying to be cocky I never was a cocky person. But this place does not deserve what I have to offer. I could look the owner in the face today and say that without a second thought. You get pushed into a corner so many times that eventually you say, "You know what? No. I'm done being that guy. I'm done

getting pushed around." At some point, you've got to recognize your worth. That's what happened to me. I finally recognized my worth and realized I'm worth way more than I'm given credit for at my job, by my friends, by my family.

In the span of like a month, I wrote 3–4 apps, business ideas I can't talk about because I have patents pending, made Algorithm Collective, created the AI audits, started building a sales team, and wrote a 40,000-word book. You know where that all came from? That came from me saying I'm done. It's time to show the world what I have to offer.

Section 8: What You Need to Remember

If there's anything I want you, the reader, to walk away with, it would be this: What you think of you is way more powerful than what people think of you. It only matters what you think.

You're going to rise and do well based on what you think. Go out there and give this stuff a try. You don't have to be perfect. I started this journey a month ago. I didn't even know I knew anything about sales. You could ask Claude, he said, "Oh, you're doing great." I'm like, "Dude, I've never done sales. Maybe you're just saying that to be nice." But I literally listened to what I was saying and how other people around me were responding, and I realized, goddamn, I am doing great.

This is crazy. Just go out there and try. I promise it doesn't hurt to try. There's nothing wrong, nothing that can happen from trying. You either get what you're going for which is great because that's the goal or you fail, and that failure makes you better. It makes you hungrier and twice as aggressive on that next call.

The only other thing I want to leave you with is the biggest thing about this sales method that deviates from traditional sales: Just treat the people you're dealing with like people.

That's what makes this so good. That's what makes this work. Just treat people like people. That's all.

Your Confidence & Action Plan

You've learned the system. You've practiced the objections. You've learned how to adapt by industry. Now it's time to look in the mirror and ask yourself: what am I actually going to DO with this? This isn't a quiz. This is a commitment. Don't just read this section and move on. Actually fill it out. Write it down. Make it real.

PART 1: THE TOXIC HABITS CHECK

Before you can build confidence, you need to identify what's holding you back. Be honest with yourself. Which of these toxic sales habits are you carrying right now?

Check any that apply:

☐ I harass customers until they hang up instead of respecting their "no"

☐ I worship the script instead of talking to people like humans

☐ I'm working somewhere with commission scams or unfair pay structures

☐ I tolerate bully managers who destroy my confidence

☐ I treat everyone as a prospect instead of qualifying leads

☐ I use manipulation tactics instead of offering real value

☐ I'm always closing instead of building relationships

The habit I need to break first:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

What this habit is costing me:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

PART 2: THE CONFIDENCE RESET

What you think of you is way more powerful than what people think of you.

Answer these honestly:

Before reading this book, how would you have described yourself as a salesperson?

What did you learn about yourself while reading this book?

What's one thing you're actually GOOD at in sales that you didn't give yourself credit for before?

PART 3: YOUR FIRST CALL PLAN

Who are you calling? (Name/company/industry)

What objection do you expect them to give you?

What do you think they'll REALLY be saying? (Not the surface objection)

Your LPR response plan:

Listen:

Process: _____Respond: _____

PART 4: WHEN YOU BLOW THE CALL (BECAUSE YOU WILL)

What went wrong?

What did I learn?

What will I do differently on the next call?

Remember my grandfather's words:

"The only man that doesn't make a mistake is the man that doesn't help at all."

PART 5: YOUR COMMITMENT

Starting tomorrow, I commit to:

☐ Treating every customer like a human being, not a commission check

☐ Using Listen-Process-Respond on every call

☐ Qualifying leads in the first 2–3 minutes instead of wasting time

☐ Walking away from customers who aren't a fit instead of forcing a sale

☐ Standing up to toxic managers who destroy my confidence

☐ Measuring my success by customer satisfaction, not just closed deals

☐ Recognizing my worth and refusing to work in exploitative environments

The one thing I'm doing differently on my very next call:

_____

_____

The person I'm going to practice this system with first:

_____

_____

When I'm making that first call (date/time):

EPILOGUE

This is how I see the new way of sales the way it always should've been. A way where people talk to each other like human beings, not numbers on a list. A way where customers aren't targets, but people you genuinely want to help. A way where sales stop being about pressure and manipulation and starts being about honesty, respect, and real relationships. Sales shouldn't be a battlefield. It shouldn't be fear driven. It shouldn't be bullying someone into a "yes." The new sales I believe in is simple:

- Help people.
- Solve problems.
- Be straight with them.
- Be human.

If the world adopted that one belief, this entire industry would look different tomorrow. Thanking the People Who Carried Me Here Before I go any further, I want to thank my job.

Not because they uplifted me. Not because they believed in me. But because they pushed me so close to the edge that I finally realized: "It's time to stop making THEM rich… and start building something of my own." That frustration became the fuel for Algorithm Collective. That anger became this book. That pressure became purpose. Sometimes the places that break you are the places that set you free.

To my sons, Brendan and Brian: You two are the reasons I wake up every day and keep moving forward. You're the reason I draw breath. You're the reason I refuse to settle. Everything I build this business, these ideas, this new life is for you. I love you both more than anything.

For Rebecca: God Rest Her Soul, to my late wife, Rebecca, my soul mate: Losing you felt like the world stopped spinning. But your memory keeps me steady and reminds me who I need to be. I hope you'd be proud of the man I am becoming.

To my Aunt Debi: You've always been like a second mother to me. You've protected me, guided me, and stood by me through every storm. You are one of the main reasons I'm still standing strong today. Thank you for everything.

To my sisters, Jessie and Carissima: I love you both. I know I'm busy building right now, but there's room here in this construction company I'm creating. We can figure it out. We can build together. Family first always.

For a Real One Jim C: Through all the chaos at work, you have always been a steady, solid man. You looked out for me when nobody else did. I appreciate you more than you know.

To the homies **Andre, Schuyler, and Gatt's:** You boys ready or what? This whole thing this company, this book is proof it's possible. We just gotta go get it. Let's build the empire. To my **Pap, Ray Killmeyer:** I still feel like the day you passed, God dimmed the lights in my world. You were one of the strongest men I ever knew, and losing you left a hole that never healed. But your strength never left

me. Your example stayed. You taught me what it means to stand tall, to work hard, and to fight through the pain. I miss you every day.

To my Uncle Ray: You might not know this, but when life got hard for me I watched you. I studied how you handled struggle. I learned how to keep pushing and keep fighting because of you. Your example kept me going more times than you'll ever realize. Because of you, I'm still standing. And to all my other aunts and uncles, who saw this little boy and stepped in and filled in all the roles you did, because you are wonderful people. Thank you, I love you

To You, the Reader

If you're still here at the end of this book, I want you to know something: You are capable of more than the world has ever seen from you. You are stronger than you've been told. You are one decision away from changing your entire life. I'm not special. I'm not chosen. I'm not lucky. I was just a guy who finally said, "I'm done waiting." And that's all it takes. Sales is not about pressure or scripts or manipulation. Sales is about people helping people. That's the future I believe in, and that's the future I'm building. Go out there and show the world what you've got.**— Ben**

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Ben Schulz spent a few years in telemarketing, but he's the guy who quit after telling a 90-year-old woman she probably didn't need the credit card insurance he was selling. He couldn't stomach manipulating people for a paycheck. For years, he thought that meant he wasn't cut out for sales. Then one day at his machinist's job, he went to his supervisor about a problem on the floor. The response? "Mind your own business." So that's exactly what he did. He went out and built a business to mind. Algorithm Collective was born from that moment a company dedicated to helping businesses get found by AI recommendation systems like ChatGPT, Claude, and Perplexity.

And this book? It came from late-night conversations with an AI assistant, practicing how to handle objections in a way that didn't feel sleazy or manipulative. Ben lives in Pittsburgh with his two sons, Brendan and Brian the reason he wakes up every day and keeps building. He dedicates this book to them, to the memory of his late wife Rebecca, his Pap Ray Killmeyer, his Uncle Ray Killmeyer, his Aunt Debi LaGamba, and all his aunts and uncles who went the extra mile for him as a kid.

This is his first book. It won't be his last.

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